

MONETARY POLICY REPORT SUMMER 2026





2%

We maintain price stability

Under the Constitution of the Czech Republic and in accordance with primary EU law, the primary objective of the Czech National Bank is to maintain price stability. The central bank contributes to sustainable economic growth by maintaining a low-inflation environment. We have been pursuing price stability in an inflation targeting regime since 1998.

We are transparent

Our monetary policy is based on a publicly announced inflation target of 2% and open communication with the public. We believe that by being transparent and predictable, the central bank assists households and companies in their economic decision-making.

We look to the future

A decision made by the CNB Bank Board today will affect inflation 12–18 months ahead. The CNB's forecast describes the most likely future path of the economy as seen by our Monetary Department's economists. The Bank Board is continuously informed about the forecast under preparation, discusses the outline of the emerging baseline scenario and asks for potential additional forecasting scenarios to be drawn up. The forecast is produced four times a year and, along with a discussion of related risks and uncertainties, is the key, but not the only, input to the CNB Bank Board's monetary policy decisions.

We decide on rates

The CNB's main monetary policy instrument is the two-week repo rate. The decision on the level of this rate sends an impulse through the financial market to the whole economy, ultimately affecting inflation in such a way as to keep it close to the target. The Bank Board meets eight times a year to discuss monetary policy issues. When making rate decisions, the members of the Bank Board discuss the current forecast and assess the newly available information and the risks and uncertainties of the forecast.

This Monetary Policy Report was approved by the CNB Bank Board on 13 August 2026 and (with some exceptions) contains the information available as of 24 July 2026. By means of this document, the CNB fulfils its statutory duty to regularly inform constitutional officials and the public about monetary developments. Unless stated otherwise, the sources of the data are the CZSO or the CNB. All the reports published to date, along with the underlying data, are available on our [website](#). A large part of the data evaluated in the monetary policy decision-making process can be found in the Chartbook, which is a parallel publication to the Monetary Policy Report.

GOVERNOR'S FOREWORD

Dear Readers,

It is my pleasure to present the third Monetary Policy Report of 2026. The Report is one of the main inputs to the Bank Board's decision-making on CNB monetary policy.

At our August meeting, my Bank Board colleagues and I kept key interest rates unchanged. The two-week repo rate thus remains at 3.75%, the level to which we increased it at the previous meeting.

Inflation has been close to the 2% target since January 2024. According to the Monetary Department's new forecast, inflation will temporarily increase slightly in late 2026/early 2027. Core inflation has remained elevated at just below 3% for eight months without showing a significant downward tendency.

Accelerating credit growth and debt financing of increased public expenditure are fostering a rise in the quantity of money in the economy. The labour market remains tight and wages are rising at a rapid pace. Prices are increasing above all in the service sector, whose price dynamics are a substantial component of core inflation. Household consumption is also increasing. Still elevated property price growth is having an inflationary effect.

The rate increase at the June meeting brought about the desired tightening of monetary conditions. The main strategy now is a period of assessing new data, the outlook, inflationary risks and the effect of monetary policy restriction.

Monetary policy currently remains relatively tight. We aim to keep headline inflation stabilised close to the 2% inflation target over the monetary policy horizon. This requires credit growth not to be excessive and, therefore, growth in the quantity of money in the economy to remain appropriate. By ensuring this, monetary policy will help keep inflation low.

To conclude this foreword, I would like to assure the public on behalf of the Bank Board that the CNB's actions will be sufficient to maintain price stability in accordance with its statutory mandate. In addition, the Bank Board is ready to react appropriately to any materialisation of the risks of the outlook for the fulfilment of the inflation target.



On behalf of the Czech National Bank

A handwritten signature in blue ink, which appears to read 'Aleš Michl'.

Aleš Michl
Governor

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THE DECISION, THE OUTLOOK AND ASSOCIATED RISKS

- At its August meeting, the Bank Board left interest rates unchanged. The 2W repo rate remains at 3.75%. The Bank Board assessed the risks and uncertainties of the outlook for the fulfilment of the inflation target as inflationary overall.
- Inflation will be close to the 2% inflation target this year. It will temporarily rise to 3% at the start of next year. Inflation will then return to close to the target, aided by tight monetary policy.
- Economic growth will slow slightly this year and pick up again next year due to a renewed positive contribution of net exports and strong domestic demand.
- Consistent with the forecast is broad stability of short-term market interest rates.

Annual inflation fell markedly to 1.5% in June, returning to levels last seen just before the outbreak of the conflict in the Middle East. Double-digit growth in fuel prices is still evident within inflation, although it declined noticeably in June due to a correction in oil prices on global markets. In May and June, inflation was dampened by a drop in food prices. Core inflation is being kept near to 3% by rising services prices. The labour market remains tight, generating significantly higher growth in real compensation of employees than in labour productivity. Wage growth in the historical context is discussed in [Box 1](#). The contribution of imputed rent to core inflation is also elevated, owing to growth in property prices, construction work prices and material costs. Throughout this year, inflation is being reduced by the one-off effect of the full transfer of the supported energy sources fee in electricity prices to the state budget. This effect will fade out next year. Food prices and retail energy prices will also start to rise again. As a result, inflation will go up to close to 3% at the start of next year. It will then return to close to the target, aided by restrictive monetary policy. In 2028, the introduction of the ETS2 emissions trading system will nudge up inflation temporarily.

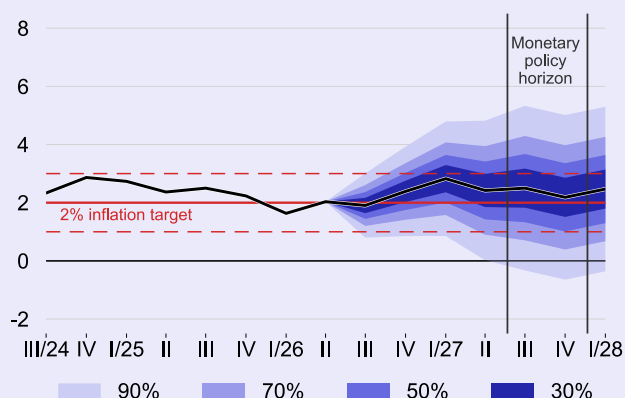
The growth of the Czech economy will slow slightly this year and fluctuate around 2.5% in the following years. The growth in the quarters ahead will be due mainly to household consumption, driven by rising real wages and a positive fiscal impulse. An expected recovery in external demand, supported by fiscal expansion in Germany, will boost growth in private fixed investment. General government investment will also rise this year amid increased take-up of EU funds. The recovery in domestic demand is linked with strong bank lending. The strongest growth is being recorded by consumer credit, which is discussed in [Box 3](#). Foreign trade is dampening GDP growth this year due to exceptionally high import growth, but in the years ahead it will make a positive contribution to growth in economic activity. The economy will be close to its potential over the entire forecast horizon.

After appreciating slightly in late May and early June, the exchange rate stabilised close to CZK 24.2 to the euro. This is the level assumed in the short-term forecast for Q3. Over the forecast horizon, faster growth in the costs of domestic firms compared with foreign ones will outweigh the exchange rate's tendency to appreciate due to convergence of the Czech economy. The koruna will therefore weaken slightly to close to CZK 24.4 to the euro. Consistent with the forecast is broad stability of short-term market interest rates. Despite the current favourable price developments, the outlook for the period ahead requires monetary policy to remain restrictive.

The Bank Board assessed the risks and uncertainties of the outlook for the fulfilment of the inflation target as inflationary overall. Persistence of core inflation is a risk in the coming months. It is reflected above all in elevated services inflation, including housing prices. A possible acceleration in the growth of the money supply in the economy caused by lending to households and general government is another domestic upside risk to inflation. A possible year-on-year increase in the public finance deficit would lead to a risk of fiscal policy having an even greater inflationary effect. Continued rapid wage growth related to persistent tightness in the labour market is an additional inflationary risk. The Bank Board will continue to closely monitor the macroeconomic impacts of the conflict in the Middle East. For the Bank Board, it is important to prevent the impacts of the conflict to date from passing through to elevated inflation expectations in the Czech Republic. By contrast, the weak performance of some euro area economies and a possible global correction of asset prices in an environment of increased geopolitical uncertainty and high levels of debt in some developed countries may have an anti-inflationary effect. Trade barriers and uncertainty connected with their intensity also remain a risk to global economic activity. The development of the war in Ukraine still represents an uncertainty.

Inflation will be slightly above the inflation target over almost the entire forecast horizon

headline inflation; y-o-y in %; confidence intervals in colours



The confidence intervals of the headline inflation forecast reflect the predictive power of past forecasts and are symmetric. They are linearly widening for the first five quarters and then stay constant. This is consistent with both the past predictive power and the stabilising role of monetary policy.

Growth in domestic economic activity will fluctuate around 2.5% in the years ahead

changes compared to previous forecast in brackets

	2026	2027	2028
Inflation	2.0	2.5	2.4
% , changes in pp	(-0.2)	(0.1)	-
GDP	2.2	2.7	2.5
y-o-y in %; changes in pp	(-0.3)	(0.0)	-
Average nominal wage	7.3	5.7	5.2
y-o-y in %; changes in pp	(0.9)	(0.3)	-
3M PRIBOR	3.7	3.9	3.7
% , changes in pp	(-0.1)	(0.3)	-
Exchange rate	24.3	24.4	24.3
CZK/EUR	(-0.1)	(0.0)	-

Green indicates a shift of the forecast to higher levels, or to a weaker koruna exchange rate, compared with the previous forecast. Red indicates a shift in the opposite direction.

1 ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENTS ABROAD

- The continuing conflict between the USA and Iran drove up oil and other commodity prices in July.
- Annual inflation in the euro area will be around 3% this year before gradually declining towards 2% in 2027.
- The growth outlook for the Czech Republic's main trading partners is relatively favourable.
- The forecast expects one rate increase from both the ECB and the Fed by the end of this year.

The Middle East conflict is making commodity prices volatile, so inflationary risks persist

The fragile ceasefire in the Middle East led to a decline in oil and other commodity prices during Q2. However, renewed clashes between the USA and Iran pushed the price of Brent crude oil to close to USD 90 a barrel in July (see [Chart 1.1](#)). The forecast assumes it will fall to USD 80 a barrel by the end of this year. The price of natural gas in Europe surged from EUR 40/MWh to above EUR 60/MWh in July, due partly to low storage levels. Moreover, the increase in other commodity prices observed after the outbreak of the conflict in early spring may feed through to consumer prices with a lag. Global inflationary risks therefore persist.

Europe is not benefiting much from solid growth in the USA and China

US GDP grew by 2.7% year on year and 0.5% quarter on quarter in Q1. Private consumption and foreign trade were the main drivers of the year-on-year growth. The positive contribution of foreign trade reflected faster export growth and a deeper year-on-year decline in imports.¹ GDP growth of 2.3% is expected for the USA in 2026 as a whole (see [Table 1.1](#)), driven by consumption and investment expenditure.

China's year-on-year GDP growth slowed from 5.0% to 4.3% in Q2. Exports are the main engine of the economy, with China successfully diversifying its export markets, often at the expense of its European competitors. Domestic demand, including investment expenditure, remains subdued. The GDP growth outlook for this year is 4.8%.

Overall, the euro area's trade balance with both China and the USA is deteriorating this year. Europe is thus not benefiting much from the solid growth in these large economies.

Chart 1.1

Oil prices rose in July following renewed clashes between the USA and Iran, with futures also increasing in response

Brent crude oil price in USD/barrel; spot price and futures; source: Bloomberg, CNB calculation

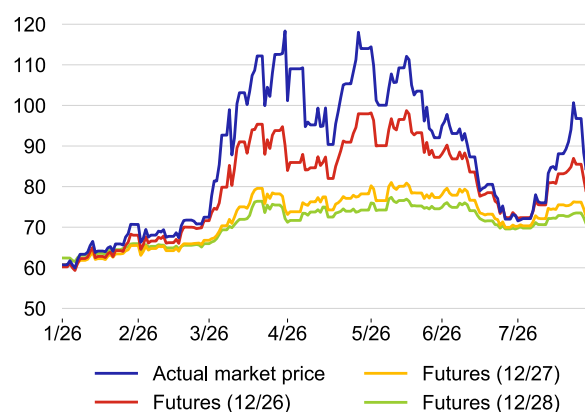


Table 1.1

Most major global economies will record slower growth this year as a result of the Middle East conflict

real GDP; y-o-y changes in %; source: CNB, Oxford Economics

	2025	2026	2025	2026	2027	2028
	Q4	Q1				
Euro area	1.2	0.3	1.5	0.5	1.2	1.2
USA	2.0	2.7	2.1	2.3	2.7	2.6
United Kingdom	0.9	0.9	1.3	1.0	0.9	1.7
China	4.5	5.0	5.0	4.8	4.6	4.4
India	8.0	7.8	7.5	6.7	6.8	6.6

¹ According to a preliminary estimate from the US Bureau of Economic Analysis, US GDP grew by 2.1% year on year and by 0.4% quarter on quarter in 2026 Q2. This information was published on 30 July 2026, i.e. after the closing date of the forecast.

The growth outlook for Germany remains solid; the euro area as a whole has recorded fluctuations due to Ireland

The euro area recorded a quarter-on-quarter decline in GDP of 0.2% and year-on-year growth of 0.3% in Q1. The overall picture was adversely affected by developments in Ireland, where GDP fell by 12.1% quarter on quarter owing to the specific role of the external sector in the Irish economy.² The weaker Q1 figure also affects annual GDP growth in the euro area.³ According to the forecast, euro area GDP growth will reach 0.5% this year and accelerate to 1.2% in the following two years.

Developments in the Czech Republic's main trading partner economies were more favourable. Government consumption and foreign trade were the drivers of Germany's quarter-on-quarter GDP growth of 0.3%, although the sustainability of the positive contribution of net exports is uncertain. The German economy is receiving support from fiscal expansion focused on defence and infrastructure, and the government plans to increase such spending further. On the other hand, economic activity is being held back by headwinds in the automotive industry and negative household sentiment linked to the geopolitical situation. The forecast expects German GDP to grow by 0.8% this year (see Chart 1.2). The Slovak economy will expand at a similar pace this year. It will accelerate next year due to the launch of new production capacity in the automotive industry. Poland recorded year-on-year GDP growth of 3.5% in Q1 (0.6% quarter on quarter). A similar pace of growth is expected for this year as a whole.

All major components of the consumer basket are contributing to euro area inflation

Annual euro area producer price inflation accelerated to 5% in Q2, mainly on the back of energy prices. Higher PPI will be driven for the rest of this year by both energy prices and its core component, reflecting accelerating GDP growth in the euro area's key economies. However, this trend is expected to reverse next year and annual producer price inflation will be very low in the second half of 2027 due to a correction in energy prices.

Annual inflation in the euro area rose to 3.2% in May before falling to 2.8% in June (see Chart 1.3). The decline in June was caused primarily by energy and fuel prices, but growth in food and services prices also eased. Nevertheless, annual services inflation remains strong, exceeding 3%. Annual inflation will rise temporarily above 3% in the second half of this year due to growth in energy

Chart 1.2

The growth outlook for Germany remains solid

annual GDP growth in %; seasonally adjusted; source: Eurostat, CNB calculation

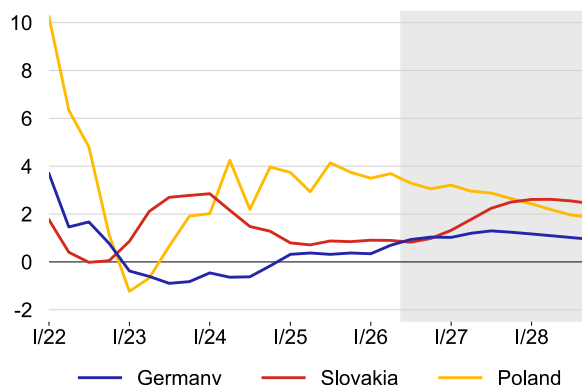
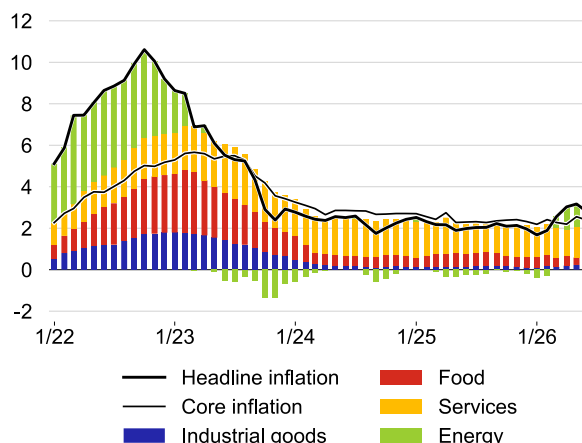


Chart 1.3

Energy and fuel prices fostered higher euro area inflation in Q2, whereas food price inflation moderated

components of euro area HICP inflation; y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp; source: Eurostat



² Excluding Ireland, quarterly GDP growth in the euro area would have stood at 0.3% in 2026 Q1.

³ According to Eurostat's flash estimate, GDP in the euro area grew by 0.4% quarter on quarter and by 1.0% year on year in 2026 Q2. At the same time, the growth in Q1 was revised to 0.0% quarter on quarter and 0.5% year on year. These figures were published on 30 July 2026, i.e. after the closing date of the forecast.

prices, food prices and items included in core inflation. Inflation is expected to gradually return to the ECB's 2% target in 2027 and to remain at that level in 2028.

The outlook for inflation, including energy prices, is reflected in expected rate increases by the ECB and the Fed

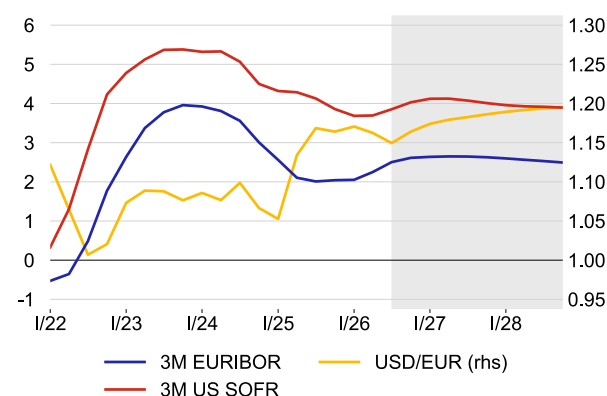
As expected, the ECB raised its policy rates by 25 bp in June (taking the deposit facility rate to 2.25%) and kept them unchanged at its July meeting. Interest rate expectations are fluctuating in line with commodity prices. At the end of July, the market outlook implied a 0.5 pp increase in the 3M EURIBOR by mid-2027. Analysts expect the ECB to raise rates in the second half of this year and to begin gradually lowering them next spring. The forecast assumes one ECB rate hike in September followed by rate stability (see [Chart 1.4](#)).

The Federal Reserve has so far kept interest rates unchanged this year at 3.50–3.75%. The combination of solid US economic growth and elevated inflation is reflected in the market outlook for the 3M SOFR, which implies one Fed rate increase at the end of this year. Changing expectations regarding the monetary policy stances of the ECB and the Fed are affecting the exchange rate of the euro against the US dollar. The euro therefore temporarily weakened slightly during Q2, while it is expected to appreciate over the outlook horizon.

Chart 1.4

The forecast assumes one rate increase in both the euro area and the USA

3M EURIBOR and 3M SOFR in %; nominal USD/EUR rate; source: Bloomberg, CNB calculation



Comparison with the previous forecast: economic developments abroad

		2026	2027	2028	
GDP (in the effective EA)	y-o-y changes in % pp	0.9 (0.1)	1.3 (0.0)	1.3 -	The GDP growth outlook for the effective euro area this year has been revised slightly upwards owing to the performance of the German, Slovak and Italian economies.
Consumer prices (in the effective EA)	y-o-y changes in % pp	2.7 (-0.3)	2.3 (-0.1)	2.2 -	The consumer price forecast for this year has been lowered due to developments in Q2 (slower growth in food prices and, in June, also energy prices).
Industrial prod. prices (in the effective EA)	y-o-y changes in % pp	2.2 (1.0)	1.5 (0.1)	0.6 -	The higher outlook for industrial producer prices this year reflects stronger-than-expected year-on-year commodity price growth observed in Q2.
Brent crude oil price	USD/barrel	84.7 (0.1)	76.2 (0.4)	72.9 -	The Brent crude oil price outlook is slightly higher than in the spring forecast owing to the ongoing conflict between the USA and Iran.
3M EURIBOR	% pp	2.4 (0.2)	2.6 (0.3)	2.5 -	The higher outlook for euro area market interest rates reflects the ECB's rate hike in June and expectations that it will raise rates further over the rest of 2026 in reaction to inflationary risks.
3M US SOFR	% pp	3.8 (0.1)	4.1 (0.5)	3.9 -	The higher outlook for US interest rates reflects stronger GDP growth and persistent inflationary pressures in the US economy.
Exchange rate	USD/EUR	1.16 (-0.01)	1.18 (-0.02)	1.19 -	Compared to the previous forecast, more gradual appreciation of the euro is expected, reflecting stronger US fundamentals and an upward shift in the Fed interest rate outlook.

Note: Changes compared to the previous forecast in brackets (a green label indicates an increase in value or a shift to a weaker dollar, while a red label indicates a decrease in value or a shift to a stronger dollar)

Effective euro area indicators are used in the external assumptions of the forecast for foreign GDP, consumer price inflation and industrial producer prices. These indicators cover the Czech Republic's six major trading partners in the euro area. Germany has the highest weight (59%), followed by Slovakia (14%), France (8%), Italy (7%), Austria (7%) and Spain (5%). The effective euro area indicators may differ from the commonly used euro area ones. However, they better capture the effect of economic developments abroad on the Czech economy.

2 THE REAL ECONOMY AND THE LABOUR MARKET

- Growth in domestic economic activity will be slightly above 2% this year and around 2.5% in each of the following two years.
- Despite slowing, wage growth will remain above average, supporting consumer spending.

The Czech economy will grow at a solid pace despite the conflict in the Middle East

In 2026 Q1, quarter-on-quarter GDP growth slowed markedly to 0.2% (2.2% in year-on-year terms). Services continued to be the main driver of gross value added growth (see [Chart 2.1](#)). By contrast, industry made a negative contribution to growth in value added.

According to the forecast, quarter-on-quarter GDP growth rose to 0.6% in 2026 Q2.⁴ Sales and production data for April and May point to a sizeable increase in the contribution of services and to growth in manufacturing activity. This is consistent with the PMI results, which have signalled improving conditions in industry for four consecutive months, with the index reaching its highest level since April 2022 in June. The forecast expects industry to continue recovering for the rest of this year as growth abroad gains pace.

Like last year, household consumption – supported by buoyant wage growth and a positive fiscal impulse – will be the main engine of economic growth in expenditure terms in 2026. Investment – particularly private investment – should also make a significant positive contribution, benefiting from the expected recovery abroad. General government consumption will continue to rise in the course of the year, but the growth will slow gradually. Net exports will make a slightly negative contribution (see [Chart 2.2](#)). Overall, GDP is expected to rise by 2.2% this year. It will accelerate to 2.7% next year, owing mainly to a recovery abroad. GDP will grow by 2.5% in 2028. The economy will converge to its potential this year and stay there until the end of the forecast horizon.

Household consumption will grow this year on the back of still swift growth in real wages

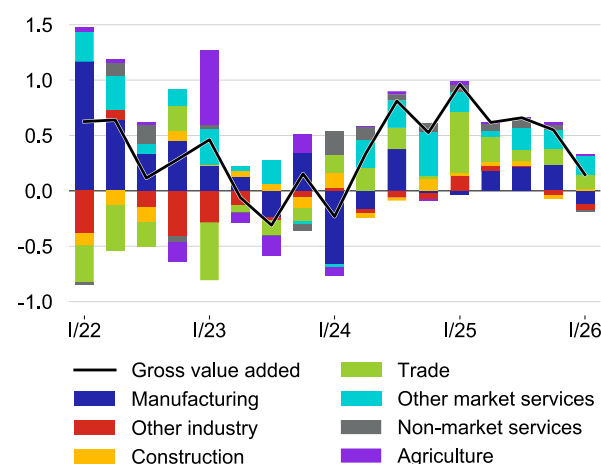
Household consumption will continue to drive economic growth. Quarter-on-quarter consumption growth slowed temporarily to 0.3% in Q1 following a strong end to the

⁴ This outcome was indicated by almost all nowcasting models, including the Rushin index. The models are described in more detail in the blog post [Vyhodnocení přesnosti AI modelů nowcastingů HDP](#) (Evaluating the accuracy of AI models for GDP nowcasting – in Czech only). According to the CZSO's flash estimate, Czech GDP rose by 0.4% quarter on quarter and by 2% year on year in 2026 Q2. These are slightly lower figures than in the CNB forecast. This information was published on 30 July 2026, i.e. after the closing date of the forecast.

Chart 2.1

Growth in gross value added was driven by services in 2026 Q1

q-o-q changes in %; contributions in pp; prices of 2020 (chain-linked); seasonally adjusted

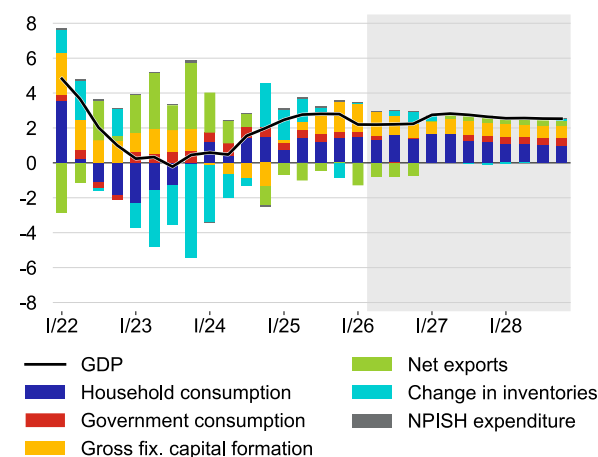


Note: Other industry comprises energy, and mining and quarrying. Trade also includes accommodation, food services and transportation. Other market services comprise information and communication activities, financial and insurance activities, real estate activities, professional, scientific and technical activities and administrative activities.

Chart 2.2

GDP will be driven mainly by household consumption and fixed investment

y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp; prices of 2020 (chain-linked); seasonally adjusted



previous year, but accelerated again in Q2 according to the forecast. The growth in consumption is supported by still buoyant wage growth and favourable consumer sentiment, despite higher fuel prices and the war in the Middle East. Accelerating consumer spending is also indicated by sales in services and retail, whose momentum increased overall compared with Q1.

Sentiment is expected to stay positive for the rest of this year, buoyed by an improving economic situation at home and abroad.⁵ Nominal wage growth will slow but will remain high. Consumption will also be supported this year by a positive fiscal impulse. A one-off increase in household consumption growth will occur in Q3 as a result of a methodological change in the classification of housing benefit, which will be moved from general government consumption. This change will affect the annual growth rate of household consumption this year and next year. The forecast expects consumption to grow by 3.2% this year, with a similar rate of growth next year. Consumer spending growth will then fall to 2.3% in 2028, partly due to lower wage growth and the expected introduction of ETS2.

Year-on-year growth in households' nominal gross disposable income is expected to reach 5–6% this year and gradually slow towards 4% next year. The growth will be determined mainly by falling growth in wages and salaries (see [Chart 2.3](#)). Gross disposable income will increase by around 4% in 2028.

The saving rate reached 20% in 2026 Q1. It will decline slightly over the rest of this year and during next year due to household consumption growing rather faster than income, although only to around 19% (see [Chart 2.4](#)). It will be kept at historically elevated levels by structural factors described in the appendix [The household saving rate in the current phase of economic growth](#) in the Autumn 2025 MPR.

Fixed investment in the private sector will surge

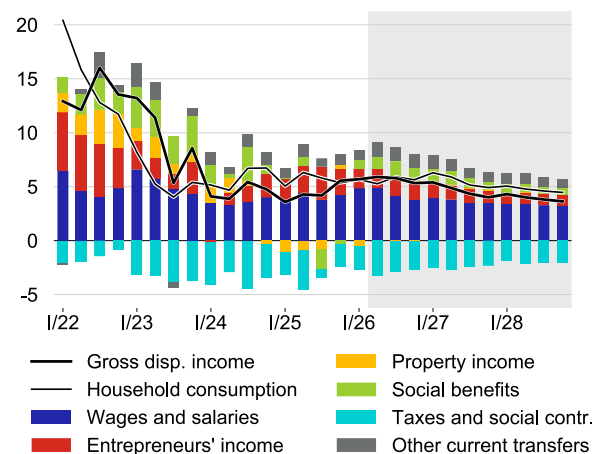
At the start of this year, private investment made the biggest contribution to gross capital formation since 2022 (see [Chart 2.5](#)). However, the quarter-on-quarter growth was driven largely by transport equipment, suggesting a one-off renewal of firms' vehicle fleets. The forecast therefore expects quarter-on-quarter private investment growth to more or less halt in Q2. From Q3 onwards, however, it will continue to rise at a solid pace due to a recovery in external demand. In 2027, it will start to slow gradually.

Year-on-year growth in general government investment slowed in Q1. For the rest of this year, the forecast expects an only modest quarter-on-quarter increase and

Chart 2.3

Growth in nominal disposable income will be determined mainly by falling growth in wages and salaries

household consumption and gross disposable income; y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp; current prices; seasonally unadjusted



Note: Entrepreneurs' income comprises gross operating surplus and mixed household income.

Chart 2.4

The saving rate will decline slightly below 20%

households' saving rate in %; seasonally adjusted

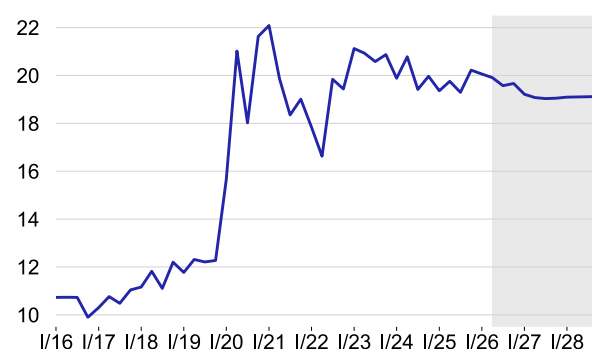
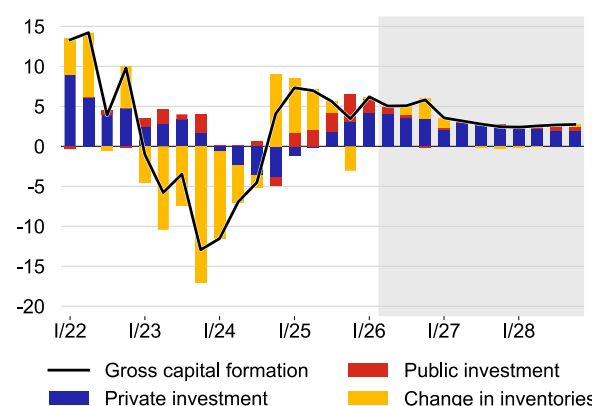


Chart 2.5

Private investment will be the main driver of gross capital formation

investment activity; y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp; prices of 2020 (chain-linked); seasonally adjusted



⁵ According to the July business cycle survey data, overall confidence in the economy remained broadly unchanged from June. Consumer sentiment is still at historically above-average levels, while corporate sentiment remains close to its long-term average.

a continued slowdown in year-on-year growth. This trend will continue into 2027, due mainly to the end of NGEU funding. Overall, fixed investment will rise by 4.5% this year. Its growth is expected to slow to 2.8% next year.

Change in inventories turned positive again at the start of this year, although it remained below its long-term average. The forecast expects a relatively rapid increase in change in inventories to levels close to the long-term average in Q2. The positive contribution of inventories to GDP growth is supported by information on stockpiling by firms due to the war in the Middle East. Overall, gross capital formation growth will reach 5.5% this year and slow to 3% and 2.6% respectively in the following years.

Fiscal policy will have an expansionary effect this year and a neutral effect in the following years

Real general government consumption growth will slow this year (see [Chart 2.6](#)). At the start of the year, the non-wage component of consumption was subdued owing to a provisional budget. However, the forecast expects the funds to be spent during the rest of the year. Nominal general government consumption growth will remain elevated this year and next year on the back of continued solid growth in compensation of employees.⁶ In 2028, nominal consumption growth will slow.

The fiscal impulse will be positive this year (see [Chart 2.7](#)), reflecting brisk growth in public sector pay, the transfer of the supported energy sources fee to the state budget and a temporary reduction in excise duty on diesel. Fiscal policy is assumed to have a neutral effect on GDP growth next year, with the restrictive contribution associated with the reintroduction of electronic sales registration (ESR)⁷ and the end of NGEU funding in 2026 being offset by the abolition of TV and radio licence fees. The fiscal impulse will also be neutral in 2028.

Export and import growth will slow year on year but remain strong quarter on quarter

At the start of this year, exports grew at the fastest quarter-on-quarter pace since 2022. The growth continued to be driven mainly by goods exports, this time mostly to euro area countries. Exports will slow in Q2 but will then pick up again as external demand improves. They will increase by 5.4% in 2026 then slow to 4.6% in

⁶ The reclassification of housing benefit from general government consumption expenditure to social benefits, effective from 2026 Q3, has a negative effect both this year and next year. To keep the impact of this reclassification on the economy neutral in the forecast, the fiscal impulse is adjusted upwards using expert judgement both this year and next year.

⁷ The restrictive impact of the reintroduction of ESR is partly offset by accompanying measures. These include a reduction in the VAT rate on non-alcoholic beverages in restaurants, the reintroduction of the child placement tax discount (kindergarten allowance) and the student tax discount, a partial lifting of the cap on leisure benefits and the introduction of one-off tax relief on sales registration.

Chart 2.6

Real general government consumption growth will slow this year

y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp; prices of 2020 (chain-linked); seasonally adjusted

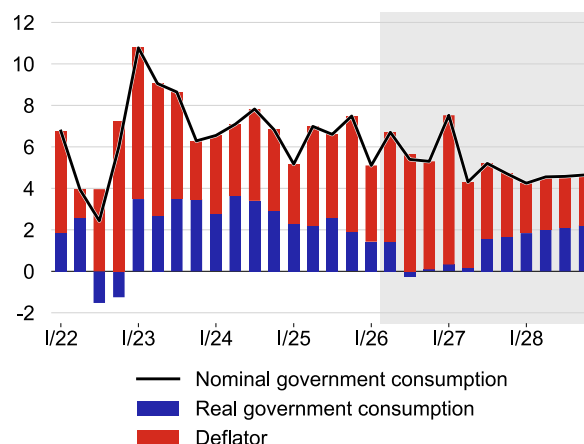


Chart 2.7

The fiscal impulse is directed mainly towards consumption this year and next year

fiscal impulse; contributions to GDP growth in pp

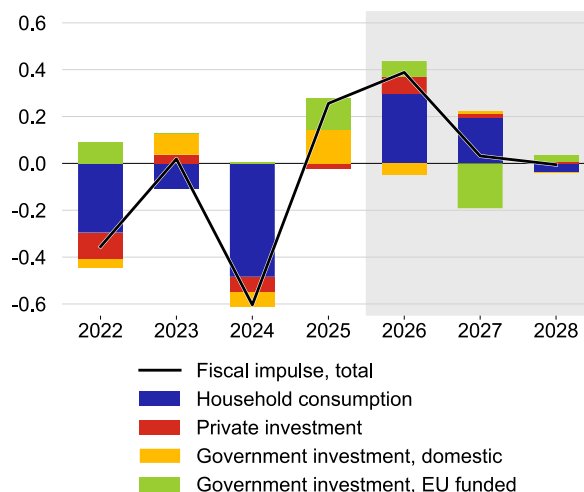
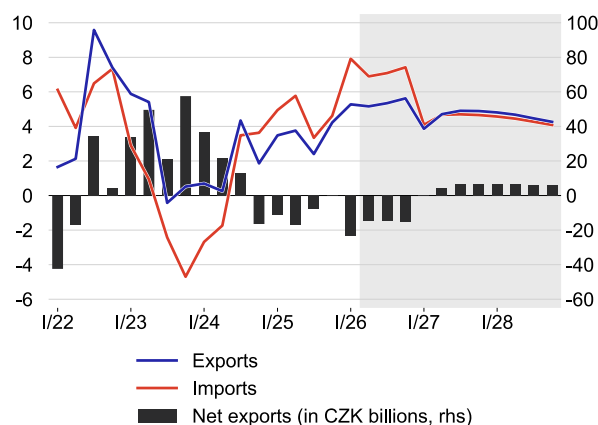


Chart 2.8

Net exports will make a slightly positive contribution in the years ahead

real exports and imports of goods and services; y-o-y changes in % for exports and imports and in CZK billions for net exports; seasonally adjusted



2027, due partly to base effects, and maintain the same rate of growth in 2028 (see [Chart 2.8](#)).

Imports rose even faster, the quarter-on-quarter growth in Q1 being the highest since 2012 (with the exception of the turbulent 2020). This was due to higher growth in exports and investment and also to their import intensity, as an increase in investment in transport equipment and a switch of change in inventories into positive territory were largely satisfied by products from abroad. Imports will increase by 7.3% in 2026 as a whole, slowing to 4.5% and then to 4.3% in the following years.

Import growth will outpace export growth this year, and net exports will thus make a negative contribution to GDP growth (−0.9 pp). In the following years, imports will broadly mirror movements in export activity, and the contribution of net exports to GDP growth will be slightly positive.

The labour market tightness will decrease this year and next year but will not vanish entirely

The LUCI shows that the domestic labour market will continue to cool gradually this year and next year. However, it will then stabilise and stay tight in 2028 (see [Chart 2.9](#)). The persisting inflationary effect of the labour market will again be due mainly to employment and to wages and costs over the entire forecast horizon. The contribution of demand for labour will also remain slightly positive.

Wage growth will slow but will remain elevated

Year-on-year growth in the average wage rose to 8.1% in 2026 Q1 (2.0% quarter on quarter). At the same time, the data for 2024 and 2025 were revised down, with wage growth at 6.6% in both years according to the latest data. Year-on-year average wage growth in market sectors reached 8.4% in Q1 and will remain above the historical average despite slowing gradually over the entire forecast horizon (see [Chart 2.10](#)). According to the revised data, wage growth in industry and market services did not differ significantly in previous years. This year, however, wage growth will be driven more strongly by market services, whereas wage growth in industry will slow somewhat more, as already indicated by available leading data on wages from the industrial production statistics for April and May. Wage growth is analysed from the long-term perspective in [Box 1](#) at the end of this section.

Wage growth in non-market sectors reached 6.9% in Q1; the salaries of staff in education and the security forces were raised in January. The buoyant growth in non-market wages will continue for the rest of this year, bolstered by an increase in the salaries of other state

Chart 2.9

From the perspective of the LUCI, the tightness in the labour market will initially decrease further and then be flat

LUCI; vertical axis shows standard deviations

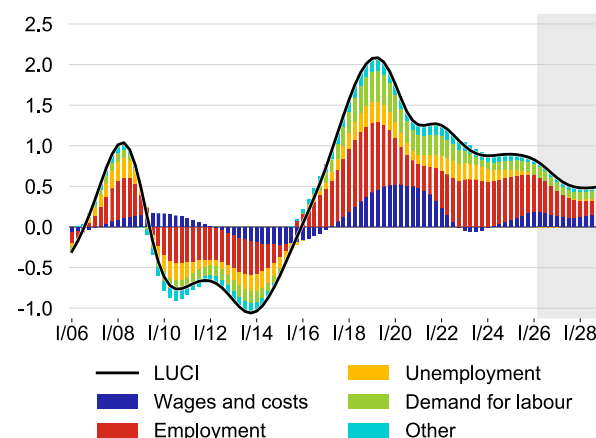
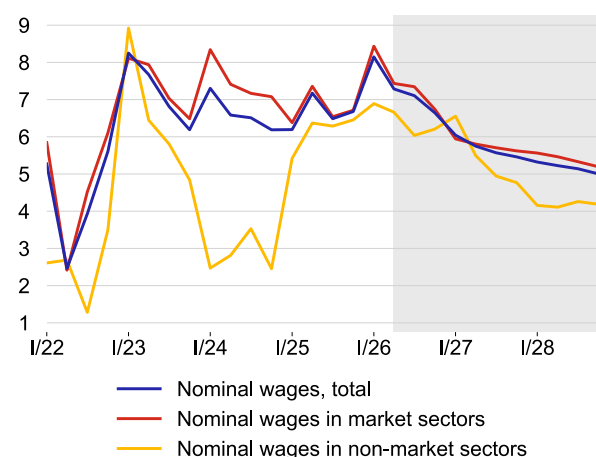


Chart 2.10

Despite slowing, nominal wage growth will remain above-average from the long-term perspective

nominal wages; y-o-y changes in %; seasonally adjusted



employees in April.⁸ According to the forecast, wage growth in the non-market sector will gradually decline over the next two years. Overall wage growth will start to slow slightly, averaging 7.3% this year, 5.7% next year and 5.2% in 2028.⁹

The average real wage rose by 6.4% year on year in Q1, one of the highest growth rates ever recorded. However, this strong growth is expected to slow in the period ahead due to lower nominal wage growth and also to higher inflation.

Unemployment will be broadly flat this year, while the number of full-time equivalent employees will increase slightly

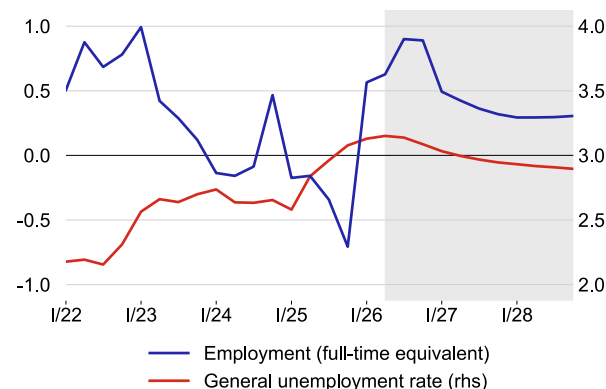
Employment expressed in terms of the number of full-time equivalent employees increased slightly year on year in 2026 Q1. At the same time, the year-on-year decline in employment in industry continued to slow. This trend is expected to persist due to a gradual recovery in external demand, and employment in industry should be broadly flat from the end of this year onwards. Market services made a slightly positive contribution to overall employment and will continue to do so over the forecast horizon. Overall, the total number of full-time equivalent employees will continue to rise gradually according to the forecast (see [Chart 2.11](#)).

The seasonally adjusted general unemployment rate stayed at 3.1% in 2026 Q1 (see [Chart 2.11](#)). It thus remains low by both international and historical standards. The seasonally adjusted share of unemployed persons registered with labour offices went up slightly, reaching 5% in June. According to the forecast, both unemployment indicators will stabilise this year and decrease slightly next year amid solid economic growth.

Chart 2.11

The number of employees will rise slightly; unemployment will stabilise as a result of an economic recovery

employment (full-time equivalent); y-o-y changes in %; general unemployment rate in %; seasonally adjusted



⁸ A broad rise in public sector wage scales on 1 April 2026 affected around 580,000 government employees. The rise ranges from 2% to 9% depending on pay grades and has the strongest impact on low- and medium-income positions in public administration and public services.

⁹ The gradual increase in the minimum wage is also contributing slightly to wage growth in the market and non-market sectors. The minimum wage rose by 7.7% in January 2026 – from CZK 20,800 to CZK 22,400. The cascade of guaranteed salaries is also linked to the minimum wage in the non-market sector.

Comparison with the previous forecast: The real economy and the labour market

		2026	2027	2028	
GDP	y-o-y changes in % pp	2.2 (-0.3)	2.7 (0.0)	2.5 -	The GDP outlook for 2026 is lower due to the data observed in the first half of the year.
Household consumption	y-o-y changes in % pp	3.2 (0.0)	3.1 (0.4)	2.3 -	The household consumption forecast is unchanged this year; next year it is mainly affected by the accounting reclassification of housing benefit and by higher growth in the wage bill.
Government consumption	y-o-y changes in % pp	0.7 (-0.9)	0.9 (-0.9)	2.0 -	The government consumption forecast is lower for both this year and next year, primarily due to the accounting reclassification of housing benefit and the observed data for Q1.
Gross fixed capital formation	y-o-y changes in % pp	4.5 (0.1)	2.8 (-0.2)	2.6 -	Growth in fixed investment is almost unchanged this year and next year.
Net exports	contr. to GDP growth pp	-0.9 (-1.1)	0.2 (0.0)	0.3 -	The contribution of net exports will be markedly lower this year due to incoming data at the start of the year.
Employment (full-time equivalent)	y-o-y changes in % pp	0.7 (0.6)	0.4 (0.2)	0.3 -	The forecast for growth in the number of FTE employees is higher, particularly for this year, due to a higher observed figure in Q1.
Unemployment (ILO)	% pp	3.1 (0.0)	3.0 (0.0)	2.9 -	The outlook for the general unemployment rate is unchanged from the previous forecast.
Average monthly nominal wage	y-o-y changes in % pp	7.3 (0.9)	5.7 (0.3)	5.2 -	The wage forecast is higher, mainly reflecting a surprisingly high observation in 2026 Q1.

Note: Changes compared to the previous forecast in brackets (a green label indicates an increase in value and a red label a decrease)

Box 1: Wage growth in the historical context: between convergence and cost pressures

The Czech economy is experiencing buoyant growth in nominal wages. Wage growth was 6.6% in both 2024 and 2025 and rose to 8.1% in 2026 Q1. These figures are well above the long-term equilibrium wage growth rate of 4.5% that is consistent with the fulfilment of the inflation target. This box analyses wage growth from the long-term perspective. It examines developments in individual sectors of the economy and places the current position of the Czech economy in the historical context in terms of the convergence process, labour costs and productivity.

Between 2019 Q4 (the last pre-pandemic quarter) and 2026 Q1, the seasonally adjusted average nominal wage in the Czech Republic grew by around 45% (nominal GDP rose by 46% over the same period). However, real wages went up by only 1.5% in the same period and did not exceed their pre-pandemic level until the start of this year (see [Chart 1](#)). The highest wage growth was recorded in some market services, but others saw weaker growth. In market services as a whole, therefore, wages increased only slightly faster than in industry. The average wage in manufacturing, the largest sector of the economy, rose at roughly the same pace as the overall average wage. By contrast, the non-market sector lagged somewhat behind the rest of the economy, especially in public administration and defence and in education. In most NACE sections, the cumulative wage growth lies within a relatively narrow range of 40–50%, and, with only a few exceptions, does not differ significantly across sectors.¹

Viewed from an even longer-term perspective, the wage growth in the Czech economy has taken place amid gradual catch-up with more advanced economies. [Chart 2](#) compares the Czech Republic with its neighbours in terms of economic level relative to the EU average and the share of labour compensation in value added.² Between 1995 and 2019, the Czech Republic's position moved mostly upwards and to the right; its relative economic level increased from about 78% to 95% of the EU average, while the share of wages in gross value added rose from just under 49% to 56%. This shift reflected the long-term process of catch-up with more advanced economies and, towards the end of the pre-pandemic period, also a tight labour market. The pandemic and the subsequent inflation shock interrupted this convergence path. After 2019, the Czech Republic's relative economic level declined and the wage share fell to around 54% in 2023. A return to convergence was apparent in 2024 and 2025.

In terms of nominal labour costs and labour productivity, the Czech economy has gone through several distinct phases since the mid-1990s.³ Between 1997 and 2004, rapid growth in compensation of employees was partly offset by strong labour productivity growth. Even so, growth in hourly unit labour costs exceeded 5% (see [Chart 3](#)). From the perspective of cost competitiveness, the period from 2005 to 2015 was characterised by a favourable combination of moderate wage growth and continued productivity growth, resulting in only very modest growth in unit labour costs. Only after 2015 did a major change occur, in connection with a tight labour market and labour shortages. Growth in compensation of employees surged, while productivity growth was no longer able to offset the wage pressures to the same extent as before. This became apparent in 2020–2023, when growth in hourly unit labour costs reached its highest levels in the period under

Chart 1

Since 2019, wages have increased the most in some market services, but industry has not lagged far behind and wage growth has been similar across most sectors

cumulative wage growth in % in NACE sections, 2019 Q4–2026 Q1; seasonally adjusted; source: CZSO

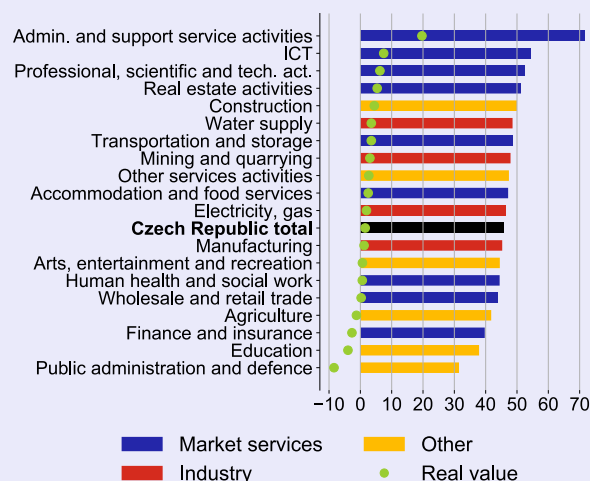
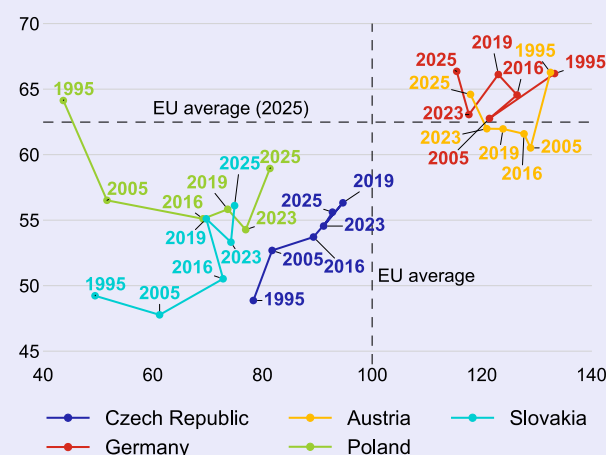


Chart 2

The Czech economy had long been converging towards the EU average in both economic level and wage share, but it is returning only gradually to a convergence path following the pandemic

x-axis: GDP per capita in purchasing power parity relative to EU average; y-axis: share of compensation of employees (converted into total employment) in gross value added; %; source: Eurostat, CNB calculation



review, while hourly labour productivity was flat. The cost pressures eased somewhat in 2024–2025, due to both slower growth in compensation of employees and renewed growth in labour productivity. However, productivity growth offset the increase in labour costs to a lesser extent than it did in the pre-pandemic period.

The sectoral breakdown for 2024–2025 (see [Chart 4](#)) also points to heterogeneity of the Czech economy. In manufacturing, there are no signs yet of productivity recovering sufficiently to offset the ongoing wage growth. A similar pattern can be seen in parts of both market and non-market services, reflecting their more limited ability to offset growing compensation by raising productivity. By contrast, productivity has increased in recent years in information and communication technology, trade and transport. Following a previous sharp decline, it has also increased in construction.

The above discussion of productivity trends in recent years is complemented by the Labour Hoarding Indicator (LHI; see [Chart 5](#)), which captures the share of firms expecting output to decrease while at the same time expecting employment to increase or remain unchanged.⁴ The LHI reached historical highs for the Czech economy following the outbreak of the COVID-19 pandemic, started to decline at the end of 2024 and is currently close to its long-term average. This suggests that during the period of heightened uncertainty associated with the pandemic lockdowns and the surge in inflation, many firms – probably partly because of their previous difficulties in recruiting suitable staff when the labour market was very tight – preferred to retain employees despite having no immediate need to utilise them fully. This is naturally associated with temporarily lower productivity. By contrast, the lower LHI values in recent quarters are consistent with the partial recovery in productivity observed already, which the forecast expects to continue over the forecast horizon.

The historical perspective shows that over past decades the Czech economy gradually converged towards more advanced European economies not only through a rising economic level, but also through an increasing wage share in value added. The pandemic and the subsequent inflation shock interrupted this process, leading to a sharp drop in real wages and weakening the link between nominal wage growth and hourly labour productivity. In 2024–2025, productivity growth recovered and the cost pressures eased, but this process has so far been only gradual and uneven across sectors. The current combination of recovering economic activity, inflation close to the target and gradually rising productivity, despite still relatively strong nominal wage growth, suggests that the wage cost pressures in the Czech economy are steadily weakening, though not abruptly.

Chart 3

The slowdown in labour cost growth in recent years has been accompanied by a modest recovery in productivity growth

decomposition of average growth in hourly unit labour costs; % and pp; source: Eurostat, CNB calculation

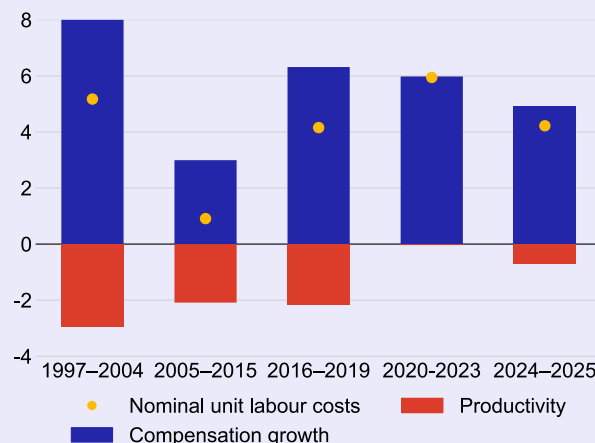


Chart 4

Productivity growth recovered only in part of the economy in 2024–2025

decomposition of average growth in hourly unit labour costs in 2024–2025; % and pp; source: Eurostat, CNB calculation

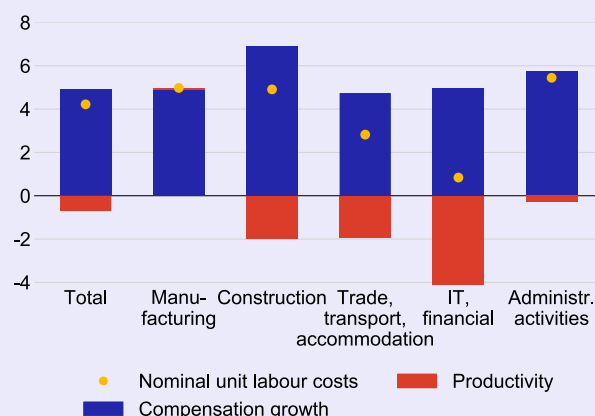
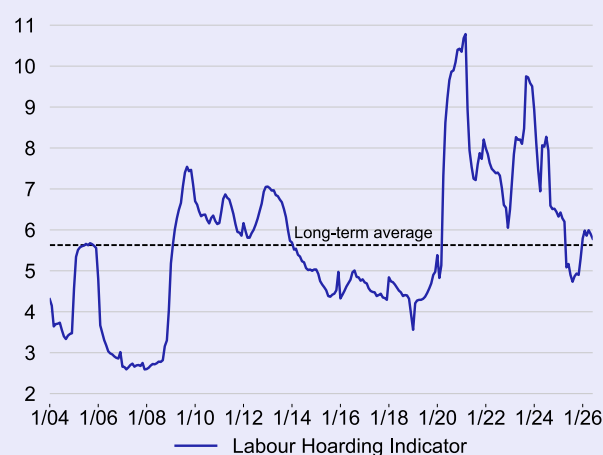


Chart 5

Following a period of record highs, the Labour Hoarding Indicator declined last year to close to its long-term average

%; weighted share of firms; 12-month moving average; seasonally adjusted; source: European Commission



¹ In administrative and support service activities, which recorded markedly stronger wage growth than the rest of the economy, temporary work agencies play an important role. As a result, this sector encompasses a diverse range of employees in terms of actual work activity.

² The analysis uses an adjusted series for compensation of employees that also considers the work performed by entrepreneurs and the self-employed. It is constructed by adding an estimated labour income component for self-employed persons to compensation of employees by converting the average compensation of employees into total employment. The resulting indicator is then expressed as a share of gross value added, which better reflects the value generated by production itself. Unlike GDP, gross value added is not augmented by net taxes on products, whose differing levels could distort international comparisons of the wage share.

³ For the purposes of this box (see Charts 2, 3 and 4), the period under review is divided into the following sub-periods: up to 2004 (the Czech Republic's accession to the EU); 2005–2015 (economic expansion interrupted by the global financial crisis and a marked slowdown in wage growth); 2016–2019 (strong wage growth and pronounced labour market tightness amid buoyant economic growth); 2020–2023 (the COVID-19 pandemic and the period of high inflation) and 2024–2025 (the resumption of solid economic growth alongside the return of inflation to the target).

⁴ The Labour Hoarding Indicator shows the weighted share of firms which, according to the European Commission's Business and Consumer Survey, expect their output to decrease over the next three months while expecting employment to increase or remain unchanged. As the indicator is based on a qualitative survey, it has certain limitations and exhibits relatively high volatility, so short-term fluctuations should be interpreted with caution. Its longer-term trend can nonetheless provide a useful complementary perspective on labour utilisation in the economy.

3 INFLATION

- Inflation will stay close to the 2% target in the coming months but will accelerate gradually.
- This will be due mainly to a gradual turnaround in food, beverage and tobacco prices. Double-digit growth in fuel prices and persistently elevated core inflation will continue to have an inflationary effect. By contrast, administered prices will dampen inflation this year.
- Inflation will peak at close to 3% at the start of next year and then slow slightly. Except for the next few months, it will therefore remain in the upper half of the tolerance band around the target.

Inflation will accelerate gradually this year

Inflation accelerated to 2% on average in 2026 Q2 (see [Chart 3.1](#)). In April, it rose to 2.5% owing to continued strong growth in fuel prices as a result of the conflict in the Middle East. In May, however, it slowed to 2.1%, mainly because of food and alcohol prices. It fell further in June (to 1.5%) on the back of both a sizeable month-on-month decline in fuel prices resulting from a temporary easing of tensions in the Middle East, and a marked deepening of the year-on-year decline in food prices. Inflation will stay close to the inflation target in the coming months.¹⁰ However, it will gradually go up, due mainly to a turnaround in food, beverage and tobacco prices, whose anti-inflationary effect will therefore fade. A year-on-year decline in administered prices will also have an anti-inflationary effect. By contrast, double-digit growth in fuel prices and persistently elevated core inflation will continue to have an inflationary effect (see [Chart 3.2](#)). Inflation will peak at close to 3% at the start of next year. It will then slow slightly. Except for the next few months, it will therefore be in the upper half of the tolerance band around the target.

Administered prices will dampen inflation this year but increase it in the coming years

Annual administered price inflation turned negative at the start of 2026 and is expected to remain in negative territory for most of the year (see [Chart 3.3](#)). This is largely due to the full transfer of the SES fee to the state budget. A decline in the commodity component of electricity and gas prices had an effect in the same direction. Owing to the conflict in the Middle East, this favourable trend will fade in the near term, and energy prices will start to rise. In 2027, there will therefore be a marked turnaround in administered price inflation, which will increase by an average of 2.5% year on year despite the planned abolition of TV and radio licence fees.¹¹ In 2028, administered price inflation is expected to

¹⁰ Inflation stood at 1.7% in July, in line with the forecast. This figure was published on 11 August, i.e. after the closing date of the forecast.

¹¹ The Czech government has approved a bill to abolish TV and radio licence fees in 2027 and transfer the funding of Czech Television and

Chart 3.1

Inflation will be in the upper half of the tolerance band around the target over almost the entire forecast horizon

headline inflation; y-o-y in %; confidence interval

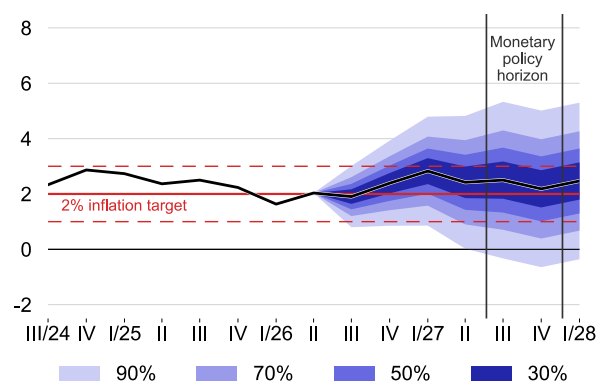
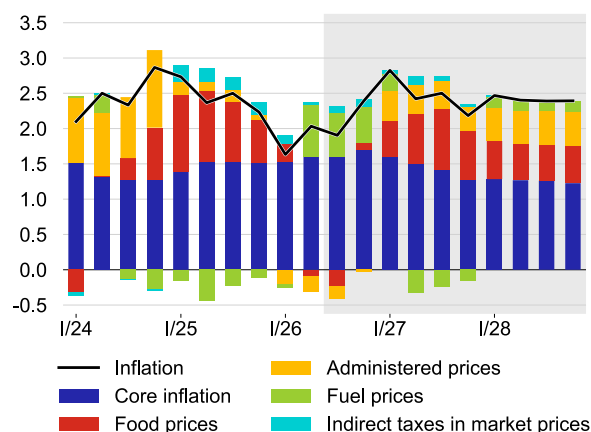


Chart 3.2

The contribution of fuel prices will be visibly positive in the coming quarters

structure of inflation; y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp



be slightly higher still due to a further increase in gas prices associated with the launch of the ETS2 emissions trading system.

The currently elevated overall inflation pressures will ease over the forecast horizon

The overall inflation pressures rose sharply in 2026 Q2 (see Chart 3.4). This was due to foreign cost pressures, reflecting higher oil and other commodity prices on global markets as a result of the conflict in the Middle East. Domestic firms thus faced rising imported energy and core prices. By contrast, the domestic cost pressures eased slightly in Q2 but remained elevated. This reflected only a modest slowdown in the still very rapid growth in market wages. The contribution of profit margins declined further in Q2, as firms had yet to fully pass the marked increase in costs through to prices, so growth in their profit margins slowed.

The overall inflation pressures will gradually ease further towards 2% over the forecast horizon. The foreign cost pressures will decrease as early as Q3 owing to a partial correction in global commodity prices. The domestic cost pressures will also drop towards their normal levels as growth in market wages gradually slows and labour productivity continues to improve. The exception will be the beginning of 2028, when the domestic pressures will temporarily strengthen owing to higher energy prices following the introduction of ETS2. Growth in margins will temporarily strengthen further in the coming quarters as firms pass on the elevated cost growth seen in the first half of this year to their prices. Domestic demand growth will moderate next year, aided by tight monetary policy, and firms will reduce their margins again.

Core inflation will remain elevated

Core inflation has been elevated for a long time (2.8% in June), mainly due to persistently rapid growth in services prices (4.5% in June). Within services prices, imputed rent is maintaining a still above-average rate of growth (5.2% in June). It is expected to stay close to 5% over the coming months owing to elevated growth in prices of construction work and materials amid an expected slowdown in growth of prices of new properties. According to the forecast, core inflation will be close to 3% this year (see Chart 3.5) and then slow gradually in the course of next year, mainly because of lower year-on-year growth in imputed rent and steadier wage growth.

Annual food price inflation will continue to dampen inflation over the rest of the year

Inflation was dampened, particularly in May and June, by food, beverage and tobacco prices, which decreased during those months. In June, it reached its lowest level

Chart 3.3

Administered prices will decline year on year in 2026 but will conversely increase inflation in the years ahead

administered prices; y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp; including taxes

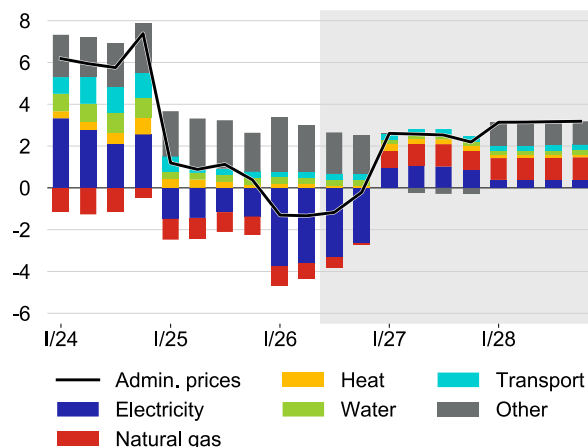


Chart 3.4

The overall inflation pressures will gradually ease

overall inflation pressures; q-o-q changes in %; contributions in pp; current prices; annualised

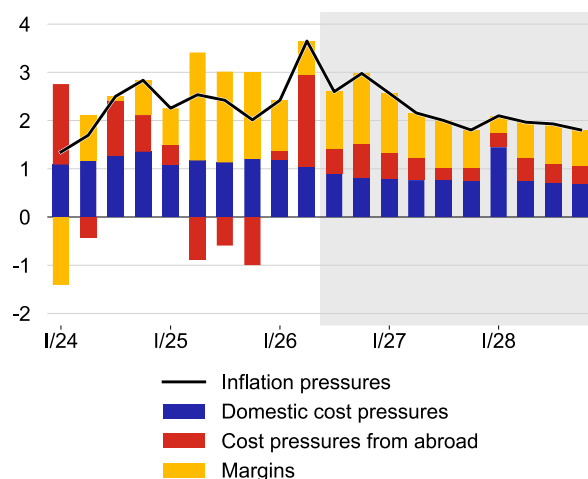
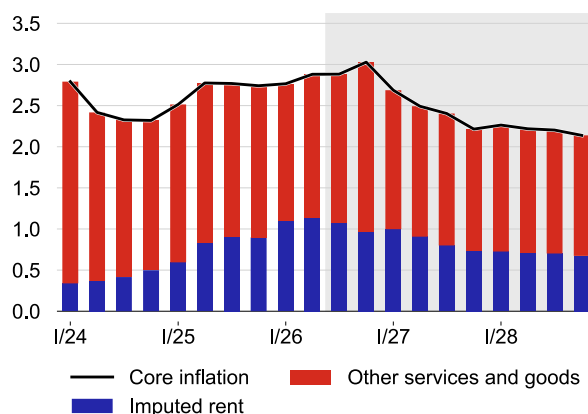


Chart 3.5

Core inflation will remain close to 3% this year and slow next year

y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp



Czech Radio to the state budget. The estimated impact of this change on headline inflation is around 0.2 pp.

in more than two years. This was due to a deepening year-on-year decline in food and non-alcoholic beverage prices, caused by favourable developments in agricultural producer prices and food industry prices. By contrast, food price inflation is expected to increase to close to 3% on average next year, partly because of a poorer harvest this year than last year.

Fuel prices are being strongly affected by the conflict in the Middle East

Fuel prices were almost 25% higher on average than a year earlier in Q2. Owing to still elevated oil prices and wholesale fuel prices, they are expected to maintain double-digit growth over the rest of this year. Next year, fuel price inflation will turn negative. In 2028, however, fuel prices will return to year-on-year growth owing to the introduction of ETS2.

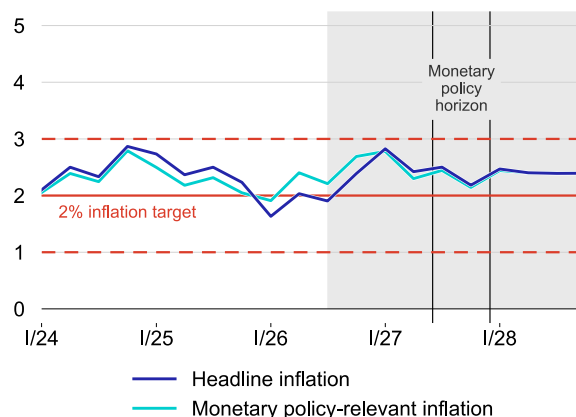
Headline inflation will be slightly below monetary policy-relevant inflation this year

This year, headline inflation is being dampened by the full transfer of the supported energy sources fee to the state budget in January. A reduction in excise duty on diesel lasting from 8 April to 19 July temporarily acted in the same direction. By contrast, an increase in excise duty on tobacco and alcohol in January (by 5% in both cases) had the opposite effect. Overall, headline inflation will therefore be slightly below monetary policy-relevant inflation this year. Conversely, it will be slightly above it in 2027 owing to a further 5% increase in excise duty on tobacco (see Chart 3.6). At the monetary policy horizon, i.e. in the second half of 2027, monetary policy-relevant inflation – like headline inflation – will be slightly above the target.

Chart 3.6

Headline and monetary policy-relevant inflation will both be slightly above the target at the monetary policy horizon

headline and monetary policy-relevant inflation; in %



*The **monetary policy horizon** (12–18 months ahead) is the future time period which the CNB focuses on when making its monetary policy decisions. It reflects the length of the transmission of monetary policy. By targeting inflation at this horizon, the central bank also abstracts from short-term inflation shocks, whose impact monetary policy can control to only a minimal extent.*

Comparison with the previous forecast: price developments

		2026	2027	2028	
Consumer prices	y-o-y changes in % pp	2.0	2.5	2.4	The inflation forecast is slightly lower this year, mainly as a result of lower food price inflation, and marginally higher next year.
		(-0.2)	(0.1)	-	
Administered prices	y-o-y changes in % pp	-1.0	2.5	3.2	Administered price inflation has been revised downwards in 2027, mainly due to the planned abolition of TV and radio licence fees.
		(-0.1)	(-1.1)	-	
Core inflation	% pp	2.9	2.4	2.2	The core inflation forecast is slightly higher next year as a result of expected stronger growth in wages and prices in industry.
		(0.0)	(0.2)	-	
Food prices (incl. alc. bev. and tobacco)	y-o-y changes in % pp	0.1	2.8	2.0	Food price inflation has been revised downwards this year due to lower observations and to a more pronounced decline in agricultural producer prices and food industry prices.
		(-0.7)	(0.6)	-	
Fuel prices	y-o-y changes in % pp	14.7	-2.0	4.5	The fuel price forecast is higher owing to the outlooks for oil prices and wholesale fuel prices.
		(1.7)	(2.0)	-	

Note: Changes compared to the previous forecast in brackets (a green label indicates an increase in value and a red label a decrease)

4 MONETARY POLICY

- At its August monetary policy meeting, the Bank Board left interest rates unchanged. The 2W repo rate thus remains at 3.75%, the discount rate at 2.75% and the Lombard rate at 4.75%.
- The Bank Board assessed the risks and uncertainties of the outlook for the fulfilment of the inflation target as inflationary overall.
- Consistent with the baseline scenario of the forecast is broad stability of short-term market interest rates.

Consistent with the forecast is broad stability of short-term market interest rates

The domestic economy will continue to grow at a solid pace despite the impacts of the Middle East conflict. The growth will be supported by continued economic expansion abroad and a positive fiscal impulse. At the same time, wages and credit will continue to rise at above-average rates. Moreover, temporary favourable factors in the form of declines in administered prices and food prices will cease to dampen inflation at the start of next year. The still elevated core inflation will thus manifest itself in full. The increase in commodity prices triggered by the Middle East conflict will gradually pass through to consumer prices. The forecast also assumes a further rise in foreign interest rates. Taken together, these factors imply a need to keep interest rates elevated in the coming quarters (see [Chart 4.1](#)). A decrease in core inflation and an expected partial energy price correction will allow rates to be lowered gradually in 2028, despite the introduction of the ETS2 emissions trading system.¹²

The koruna will be broadly stable over the outlook horizon

Following an earlier depreciation, the koruna strengthened overall against the euro during 2026 Q2, primarily reflecting changes in financial market sentiment related to the Middle East conflict. At the beginning of April, the exchange rate was fluctuating around CZK 24.5 to the euro. In mid-June, it reached CZK 24.1 to the euro (its strongest level since December 2025). Despite the CNB raising interest rates in June, the koruna shed part of its gains in the second half of June (mainly due to the dollar strengthening against the euro). At the end of the quarter, the exchange rate was close to CZK 24.2 to the euro.

Chart 4.1

Consistent with the forecast is broad stability of short-term market interest rates

3M PRIBOR in %; confidence interval

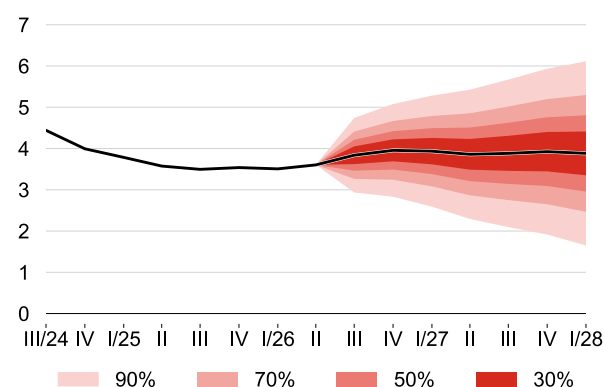
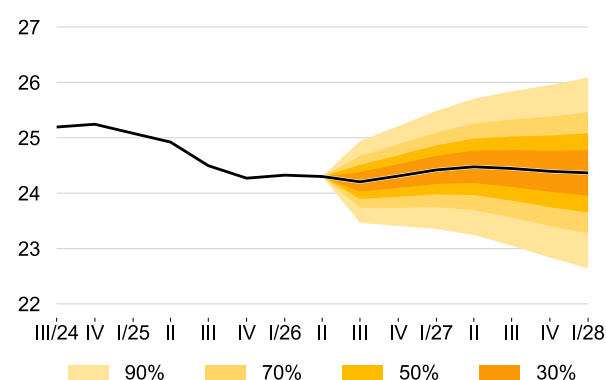


Chart 4.2

The koruna will be broadly stable over the outlook horizon

CZK/EUR exchange rate; confidence interval



¹² ETS2 aims to impose a charge at the EU level on greenhouse gas emissions from road transport, building heating and small-scale energy and industrial production through emission allowances. In the baseline scenario, the central bank looks through the primary impacts of the introduction of ETS2, which add 0.4 pp to consumer price inflation. By contrast, it prevents the secondary impacts, equivalent to 0.2 pp, by means of slightly higher interest rates.

The baseline scenario of the summer forecast expects the koruna to average CZK 24.2 to the euro in 2026 Q3. The exchange rate will then weaken slightly to CZK 24.4 to the euro over the outlook (see [Chart 4.2](#)) owing to a modest decline in the external surplus of the economy and the competitive disadvantage faced by domestic firms due to their costs rising more strongly than those of foreign firms.

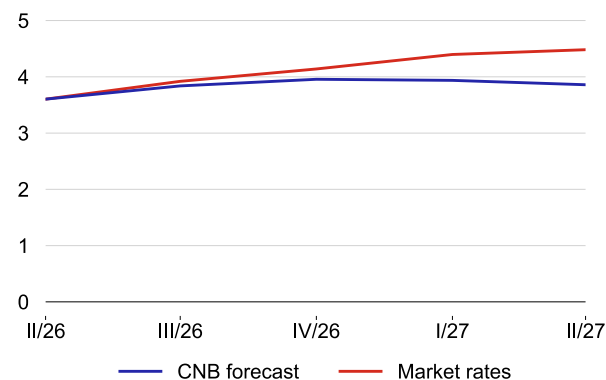
The market interest rate outlook is in line with the CNB's summer forecast for the next few quarters

At its June meeting, the CNB Bank Board increased the 2W repo rate by 0.25 pp to 3.75%. The market outlook for short-term FRA rates shifted slightly higher. At the end of July, the market was expecting the 3M PRIBOR to rise gradually (see [Chart 4.3](#)). The interest rate path in the baseline scenario of the CNB's summer forecast expects rates to increase slightly in late 2026.

Chart 4.3

The market was expecting rates to stay unchanged at the August meeting; the market outlook for the first half of next year is slightly above the CNB forecast

3M PRIBOR, FRA in %



Note: Market rates represent for 2026 Q2 the 3M PRIBOR and for 2026 Q3–2027 Q2 the average values of the FRA 1*4, 3*6, 6*9 and 9*12 rates for the last 10 trading days as of 31 July 2026.

*The **3M PRIBOR market interest rate** is a money market reference rate with a maturity of three months which is closely linked to the CNB's monetary policy rates. The CNB's key rate is the **two-week (2W) repo rate**, paid on commercial banks' excess liquidity as absorbed by the CNB in repo operations. The difference between the 3M PRIBOR and the 2W repo rate fluctuates over time and reflects, among other things, expectations regarding the nearest path of monetary policy interest rates. Before the CNB Bank Board's August monetary policy meeting, this difference was slightly positive.*

Comparison with the previous forecast: interest rates and the exchange rate

Chart 4.4

The interest rate path is slightly higher than in the spring forecast

decomposition of changes in 3M PRIBOR forecast in pp

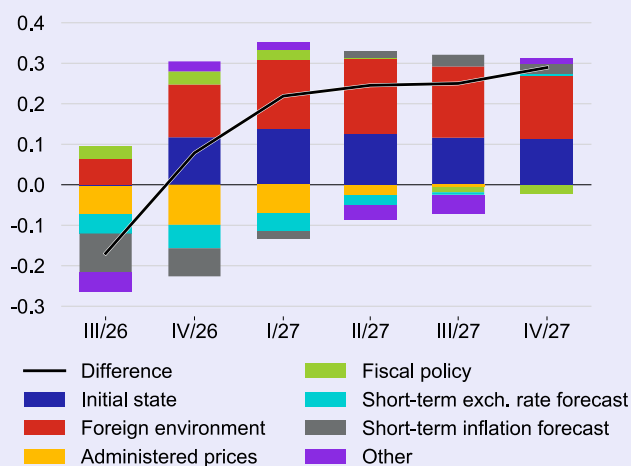
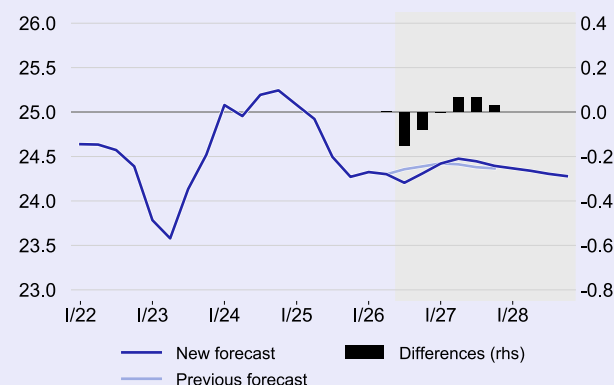


Chart 4.5

The exchange rate will be slightly stronger over the rest of this year than in the spring forecast

change in CZK/EUR exchange rate forecast; differences in CZK – right-hand scale



Comparison of the interest rate path with the previous forecast (see Chart 4.4)

- The **initial state** fosters slightly higher rates. Inflation pressures stemming from stronger wage growth outweigh the weaker economic activity recorded in the first half of this year. The change in import prices in 2026 Q2 also makes a positive contribution. The contribution of the initial state is dampened at first by the interest rate smoothing effect.
- The positive contribution of the **foreign environment** reflects stronger foreign price pressures arising from higher energy prices and a higher outlook for the 3M EURIBOR.¹³ A higher outlook for the US 3M SOFR also plays a role.
- The contribution of the **short-term inflation forecast** reflects lower expected inflation in 2026 Q3 due to lower food prices.
- A lower outlook for **administered prices** has an anti-inflationary effect. This reflects the planned abolition of TV and radio licence fees next year.
- The other contributions are negligible.

Comparison of the koruna exchange rate outlook with the previous forecast (see Chart 4.5)

- Compared with the spring forecast, the exchange rate will be stronger for the rest of this year, owing to an increased preference for the Czech economy among investors. Over the rest of the outlook horizon, the exchange rate forecast is virtually unchanged from the spring forecast.

¹³ Given the ECB's cautious stance, the forecast incorporates an adjusted outlook for the 3M EURIBOR assuming a single ECB rate increase in late 2026, followed by constant rates until the second half of 2027 and then a gradual decline. By contrast, the financial market expects tighter monetary policy in the coming years.

Most analysts expect broad stability of the CNB's key interest rate and the exchange rate at the one-year horizon

All the respondents in the FMIE survey were expecting rates to be left unchanged at the August monetary policy meeting. Most of the respondents expect the CNB's key interest rate to also remain at the current level over the next 12 months. Their estimates range between 3% and 4% (median 3.75%). On average, the analysts expect the koruna to be close to CZK 24.1 to the euro one year ahead (see Table 4.1). Their forecasts thus expect a slightly stronger exchange rate than the central bank's outlook.

Inflation expected by financial market analysts stood at 2.6% at the one-year horizon and stayed slightly above the CNB's 2% target at the three-year horizon (see Chart 4.6).

Inflation expectations of firms are above the 2% target

According to a joint survey conducted by the Confederation of Industry and the CNB, the inflation expectations of non-financial corporations one year ahead remained slightly below 3% in June (see Table 4.1). Firms are also asked about the prices of their main inputs (commodities, materials, energy, etc.) one year ahead. This forward-looking indicator decreased slightly to 2.8%. In the case of prices of firms' main outputs (final products), it stood at 2.7%.

Inflation perceived by domestic households in the European Commission survey has mostly been declining in recent months and reached an eight-year low in July 2026. The inflation rate expected one year ahead (see Chart 4.6) has fallen again in recent months after increasing during the spring.

PRIBOR rates rose slightly, while rates with longer maturities fluctuated in line with developments in the Middle East

While interest rates with shorter maturities were affected by the June increase in the CNB's key rates, rates with longer maturities (over one year) responded mainly to developments in the Middle East conflict. After rising sharply by as much as 1 pp in just a few days at the start of March, domestic and foreign rates (IRS rates and government bond yields) gradually stabilised (see Chart 4.7). Stock indices recovered relatively quickly from their March declines; the VSTOXX (EU) and VIX (USA) implied volatility indices returned to the low-volatility range. Interest rates, however, did not go back to their end-February levels, as commodity prices cannot be expected to return to the levels seen before the war in Iran even if the conflict ends soon and the Strait of Hormuz is reopened. The market assumes that the global inflationary shock will gradually pass through to economies, forcing central banks to become more

Table 4.1

Analysts' inflation expectations at the three-year horizon are slightly above the 2% target; those of firms are at 3%

sample of approximately 18 analysts and 150 corporations; 1Y horizon; annual percentage changes unless otherwise indicated

FMIE:	3/26	4/26	5/26	6/26	7/26
CPI	2.4	2.7	2.7	2.6	2.6
CPI, 3Y horizon	2.1	2.1	2.2	2.2	2.2
Real GDP in 2026	2.5	2.2	2.0	2.1	2.1
Real GDP in 2027	2.5	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.4
Nominal wages in 2026	6.0	6.0	6.1	6.8	6.9
Nominal wages in 2027	5.3	5.2	5.2	5.6	5.6
CZK/EUR exchange rate (level)	24.2	24.3	24.3	24.2	24.1
2W repo rate (%)	3.5	3.5	3.6	3.7	3.7
1Y PRIBOR (%)	3.6	3.7	3.8	3.8	3.9
Corporations:					
CPI	2.6			2.7	
CPI, 3Y horizon	3.0			3.0	

Chart 4.6

Inflation expectations remain slightly elevated

sample of approximately 18 analysts, 150 corporations and 1,000 households; %; 1Y horizon

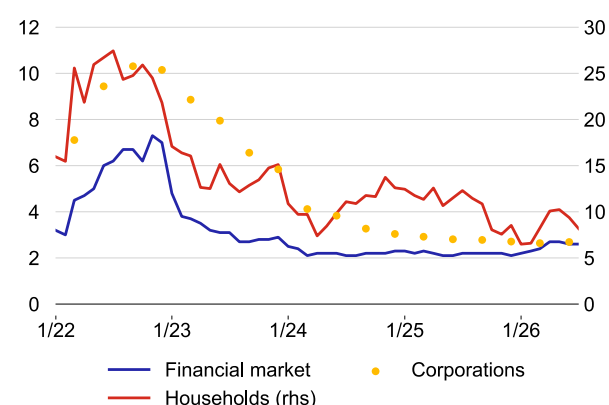
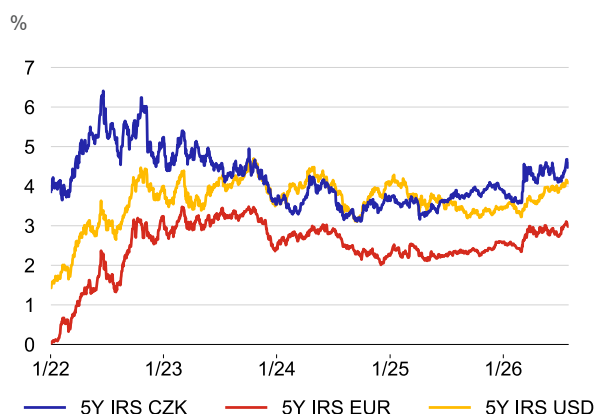


Chart 4.7

Domestic interest rates with longer maturities responded mainly to events in the Middle East



restrictive. Moreover, the situation in the Middle East escalated at the start of July after a temporary ceasefire between the USA and Iran was breached. Domestic IRS rates have risen by 0.7 pp at most maturities since the start of this year. The same goes for government bond yields. Long-term financing conditions have thus tightened autonomously. The slope of the government bond yield curve remains positive (see [Chart 4.8](#)).

Client interest rates rose slightly in Q2

The interest rate on new loans to non-financial corporations rose slightly to 5.4% in Q2 in response to the increase in monetary policy rates (see [Chart 4.9](#)). The rate on koruna-denominated corporate loans was 1.4 pp higher on average than that on euro loans. Rates on loans to households also increased slightly. The rate on new loans for house purchase rose to 4.6%, while that on consumer credit returned to around 7.9% after falling markedly at the start of the year. The distribution of client rates is discussed in [Box 2](#) at the end of this section.

Growth in loans to non-financial corporations is picking up gradually

Growth in corporate loans accelerated further to 8.7% in Q2. According to the Bank Lending Survey, demand for loans also increased further in Q2. It reflected financing of fixed investment, corporate acquisitions and working capital, as well as lower interest rates. The growth in loans was due mainly to koruna loans, while the share of foreign currency loans in total loans to corporations remained close to 48%. In terms of sectors, loans increased in services, real estate activities, wholesale and retail trade and industry. According to the forecast, growth in loans to corporations will remain broadly stable in the second half of 2026, as the current growth in private investment will slow only gradually owing to an expected expansion abroad. In 2027, growth in loans to corporations will slow more markedly to just above 5% (see [Chart 4.10](#)).

Growth in loans to households rose markedly

The annual growth rate of housing loans to households rose further, reaching 9.4% in Q2. This reflected a still large amount of genuinely new mortgages, which reached a historical high in April (see [Chart 4.11](#)). This is in line with statements by banks, which perceived a marked increase in demand linked with the announced tightening of the requirements for the provision of investment mortgages in April and the expected rise in mortgage rates. In June, the seasonally adjusted volumes of genuinely new mortgages decreased to the levels observed at the start of this year. According to the forecast, growth in housing loans will gradually slow in the quarters ahead, mainly as a result of frontloading in the first half of this year and an expected slowdown in property price growth.

Growth in consumer credit surged to 15.2% in Q2. According to banks, the higher demand for these loans was driven mainly by growth in consumer spending and

Chart 4.8

The Czech government bond yield curve is slightly rising

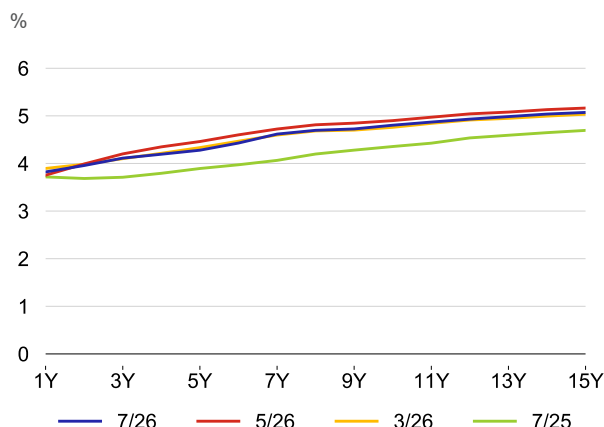


Chart 4.9

Interest rates on loans to corporations and loans for house purchase rose slightly

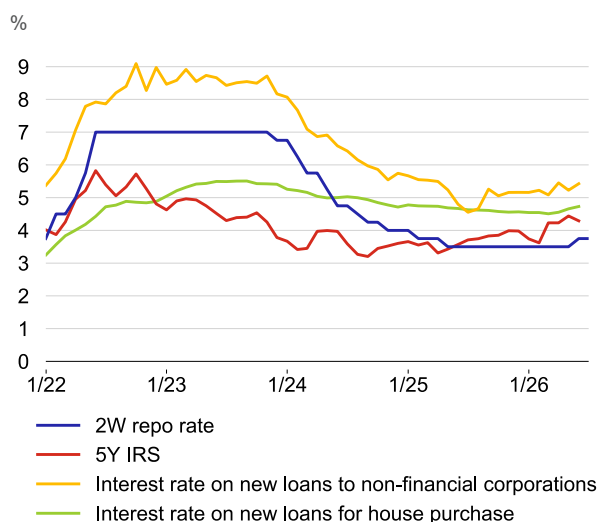
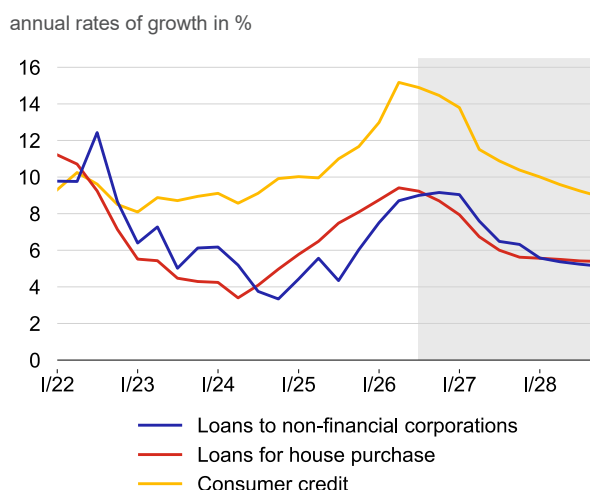


Chart 4.10

Growth in loans to the private sector will remain high this year



a decline in interest rates offered. **Box 3** (at the end of this section) shows that the current high growth in consumer credit is also due to continued strong growth in housing loans. The forecast expects consumer credit growth to start to decrease gradually at the end of this year, in line with expected consumption growth and the slowdown of the mortgage market.

Growth in the quantity of money in the economy accelerated further

The annual growth rate of M3 accelerated to 6% in Q2 (see **Chart 4.12**). The main sources of M3 growth were continued rising growth in loans to the private sector and an elevated contribution of loans to general government. Net foreign assets also contributed positively to M3 growth. M1 continued to grow slightly faster than M3 in Q2, reflecting a persisting preference for more liquid overnight deposits. M3 growth can be expected to average 6% this year, in line with the strong growth in lending to the private sector.

Real monetary conditions are restrictive in both the interest rate and exchange rate components

The interest and exchange rate components of the real monetary conditions are both currently mildly restrictive. Overall, monetary conditions will remain restrictive over the forecast horizon, with the interest rate component continuing to exert a restrictive effect, while the exchange rate component will be broadly neutral (see **Chart 4.13**).

Higher energy prices are an inflationary risk of the forecast

Peace negotiations in the Middle East are proving very difficult. The ceasefire agreed in June, which led to a marked decline in oil and gas prices, lasted only a few weeks. The subsequent breakdown of the peace talks resulted in a renewed rapid increase in the prices of these commodities. The summer forecast assumes that the oil price will average around USD 83 a barrel in 2026 Q3. In July, however, it fluctuated between USD 70 and USD 100 a barrel. In addition to oil price volatility, the price of gas represents a significant risk. The forecast assumes a gas price of EUR 55/MWh for 2026 Q3. In late July, however, the gas price remained close to its spring peak of EUR 60/MWh given relatively low storage levels in Europe and the outlook for replenishing stocks ahead of the heating season.

Tensions in the Middle East could also lead to higher prices of other commodities and goods, while also worsening the supply chain situation.

The impacts of the introduction of the ETS2 emissions trading system are an uncertainty of the forecast

The planned introduction of ETS2 in 2028 is associated with uncertainty regarding the price at which emission allowances will be traded and how that price will pass

Chart 4.11

The volumes of new mortgages remain high despite having declined in recent months

genuinely new mortgages, including increases; CZK billions

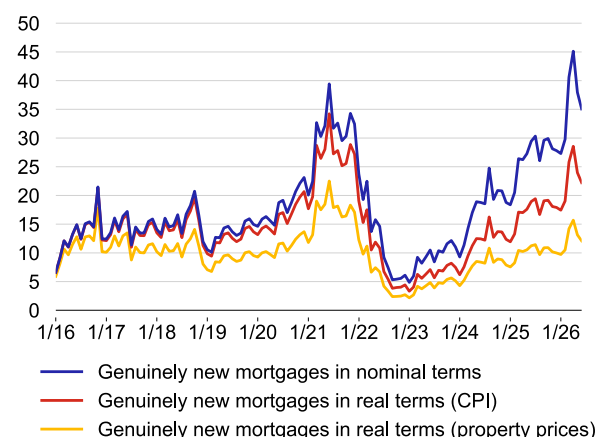


Chart 4.12

M3 growth accelerated further in Q2

annual rates of growth in %; contributions in pp

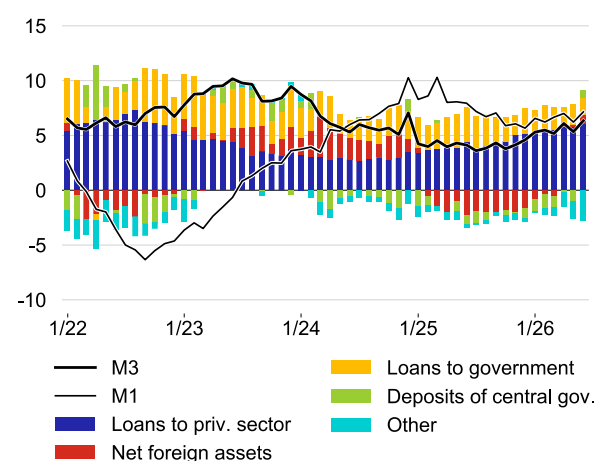
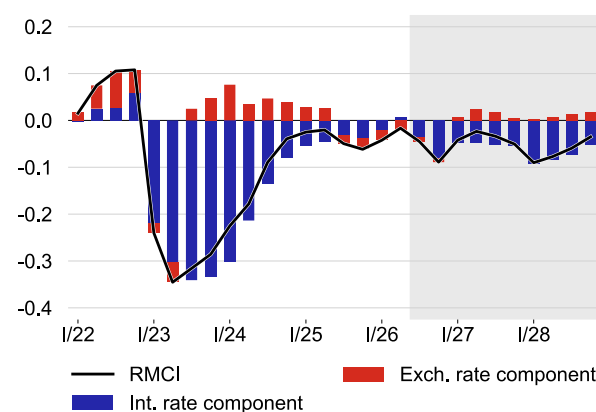


Chart 4.13

Real monetary conditions will remain restrictive according to the forecast

real monetary conditions index (RMCI); positive (negative) values correspond to easy (tight) monetary conditions



Note: The deviations of ex ante real interest rates and the real exchange rate from their equilibrium levels enter the real monetary conditions index (RMCI).

through to consumer prices. The baseline scenario of the forecast assumes that monetary policy will look through the primary price impact of this administrative measure. However, the size of the secondary impacts – to which the central bank will respond – will depend on the price of the allowances. At the same time, there is currently uncertainty regarding any compensatory measures to be implemented by the Czech government and the potential further postponement of the introduction of ETS2.

The effect of domestic fiscal policy remains an uncertainty of the forecast

The forecast incorporates fiscal measures that have either been approved or entered the legislative process,¹⁴ and expects a general government deficit of 2.6% of GDP this year and 2.9% of GDP next year. The uncertainty regarding fiscal policy relates to increases in defence and infrastructure spending and to the budgetary benefits of the reintroduction of electronic sales registration (ESR). It also pertains, to a significant extent, to 2028, for which the government-approved Czech Fiscal-Structural Plan envisages a reduction in the general government deficit to 2% of GDP. However, the specific measures intended to achieve this improvement have not yet been presented. At the same time, the domestic budgetary rules are likely to be relaxed. The CNB forecast expects a continued deficit of 2.9% of GDP in 2028.

The future development of property prices also remains an uncertainty of the forecast

The housing market has now passed its peak in terms of price growth. Year-on-year growth in asking prices slowed further in 2026 Q2 but remained in double digits (10.7%, compared with 12.9% in Q1; see [Chart 4.14](#)). Quarter-on-quarter growth also slowed (to 1.4%, down from 2.7% in Q1). A strong demand situation continues to prevail in the domestic economy, accompanied by a large amount of genuinely new mortgages (see [Chart 4.11](#) above). The baseline scenario of the forecast expects growth in new property prices to continue to ease. However, uncertainty persists regarding the magnitude of this expected slowdown.

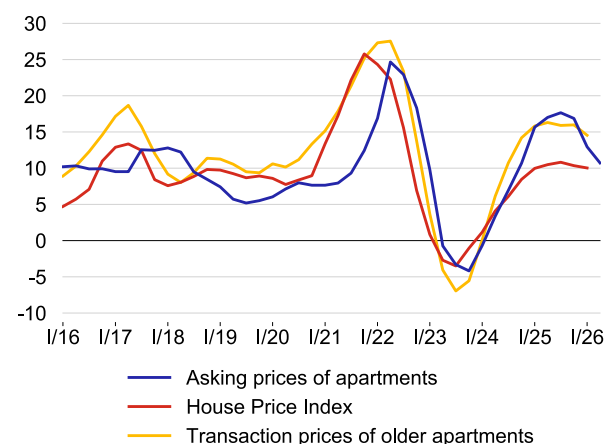
Heightened geopolitical tensions related to the ongoing war in Ukraine remain a general uncertainty of the forecast.

The Inflation and Monetary Policy Risks Scoreboard identifies the general government balance, growth in inflation expectations and strong lending activity as the most significant inflationary risks

Chart 4.14

Year-on-year growth in residential property prices is slowing but remains high for now

y-o-y changes in %



¹⁴ For example, the abolition of TV and radio licence fees, the reintroduction of ESR and associated tax changes and relief measures, and an increase in parental allowance.

The Scoreboard¹⁵ continues to identify the general government deficit as the most intense inflationary risk. The deficit is expected to widen further this year (to 2.6% of GDP), mainly due to the full transfer of the SES fee to the state budget and the loss of windfall tax revenues. The persisting deficit is reflected in a positive contribution of general government financing to money growth in the economy (see [Chart 4.12](#) above). This could support household consumption and create inflationary pressures in the domestic economy over the medium to long term. The Scoreboard also identifies increased lending activity and elevated inflation expectations as further significant inflationary risks. In addition, it now indicates an inflationary effect of oil and construction material prices associated with the conflict in the Middle East. According to the Scoreboard, the domestic labour market and property prices are continuing to generate modest inflationary risks. By contrast, agricultural producer prices and most external relations indicators are still sending an anti-inflationary message.

¹⁵ The Scoreboard provides information on the underlying inflationary environment in the domestic economy and is published together with the Monetary Policy Report on the CNB website (under *Chartbook and underlying data*). The Scoreboard data are already largely taken into account in the baseline scenario of the forecast.

Box 2: How do banks and their clients react to changes in the CNB's interest rates?

To illustrate the effect of changes in the CNB's two-week repo rate on client rates, this box examines the distributions of client rates for households and corporations¹ between the end of 2023 and June 2026. Over this period, the CNB lowered its policy rates substantially (by more than 3 pp). The two-week repo rate declined from 7% in December 2023 to 3.5% in May 2025. At the end of the period under review, the rate was increased to 3.75%.

The pass-through of monetary policy and market rates to client rates on koruna-denominated loans to non-financial corporations is traditionally very rapid. Client rates on most koruna-denominated loans to non-financial corporations are contractually linked to the PRIBOR plus a credit margin, meaning that changes in market rates pass through to client rates virtually immediately. The gradual reduction of the two-week repo rate from 7% in December 2023 to 4% in December 2024 was reflected in a pronounced shift in the mode of the distribution towards lower interest rates (see [Chart 1](#)). Following the subsequent reduction of the repo rate to 3.5% in May 2025, the largest volumes of koruna-denominated loans were still concentrated in the 5–6% band. However, the volumes of loans drawn at those rates were significantly higher, and loans drawn at lower rates also rose. A similar pattern was observed for euro-denominated loans to non-financial corporations (see [Chart 2](#)), reflecting the 2 pp decline in the ECB's deposit facility rate between December 2023 and June 2025. In recent years, euro loans have accounted for roughly one-half of total loans to corporations.

Chart 1
Koruna-denominated loans to non-financial corporations

x-axis: interest rate bands in %; y-axis: volumes in CZK billions; stocks of koruna-denominated loans

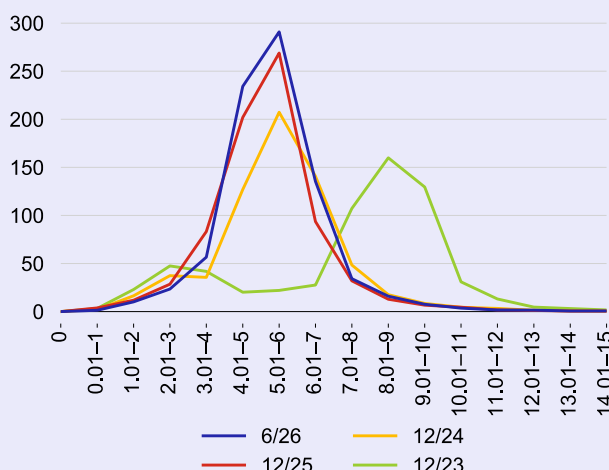
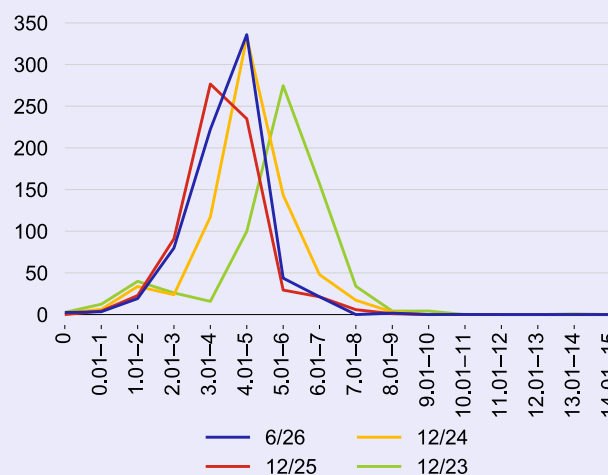


Chart 2
Euro-denominated loans to non-financial corporations

x-axis: interest rate bands in %; y-axis: volumes in CZK billions; stocks of euro-denominated loans



The distribution of client interest rates on housing loans has changed markedly over the past two and a half years. At the end of 2023, households still predominantly held mortgage loans with interest rates in the 2–3% range as a result of the accommodative monetary policy of previous years (see [Chart 3](#)), while the volume of new loans drawn at higher interest rates was minimal (see [Chart 4](#)). As the two-week repo rate gradually declined and borrowers increasingly needed to refix previously agreed loans, mortgages in the 4–5% band became more common. This was reflected in a change in the distribution of total housing loans. Whereas originally the distribution had a single pronounced peak in the 2–3% range, from 2025 onwards it has exhibited two distinct peaks – on the left, mortgages obtained at lower rates (not yet refinanced or refixed), and on the right, newer mortgages already bearing higher rates (see [Chart 3](#)). A change in policy rates therefore passes through more slowly to client rates on mortgages than to those on corporate loans. On the other hand, it affects not only the decisions of prospective new mortgage clients, but also the disposable income of existing borrowers who need to refinance or refix their mortgages.

Chart 3
Housing loans

x-axis: interest rate bands in %; y-axis: volumes in CZK billions; stocks of loans

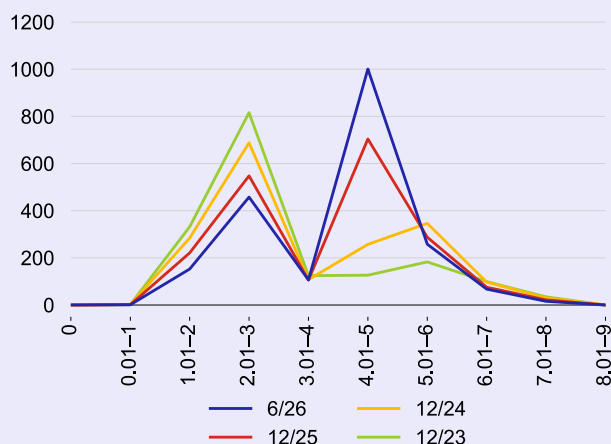
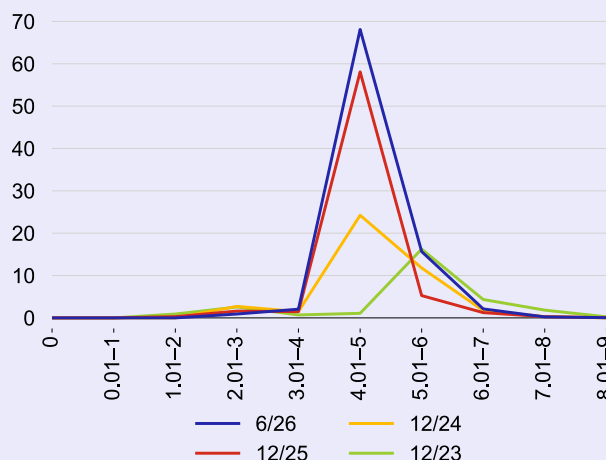


Chart 4
New housing loans

x-axis: interest rate bands in %; y-axis: volumes in CZK billions; new loans



Given that both corporations and households hold a large proportion of their deposits in non-interest-bearing accounts, the pass-through of monetary policy rates to client deposit rates is very fast. At the end of 2023, corporate deposits were concentrated around rates of 6–7% (see [Chart 5](#)), while the mode for rates on household deposits was around 1 pp lower (see [Chart 6](#)). This suggests that firms were able to negotiate better rates. As the two-week repo rate came down, the situation became more balanced and the distributions of rates on corporate and household deposits had a similar shape. The latest figures show a renewed increase in rates, reflecting an upward shift in the yield curve.

Chart 5
Deposits of non-financial corporations

x-axis: interest rate bands in %; y-axis: volumes in CZK billions; stocks of deposits

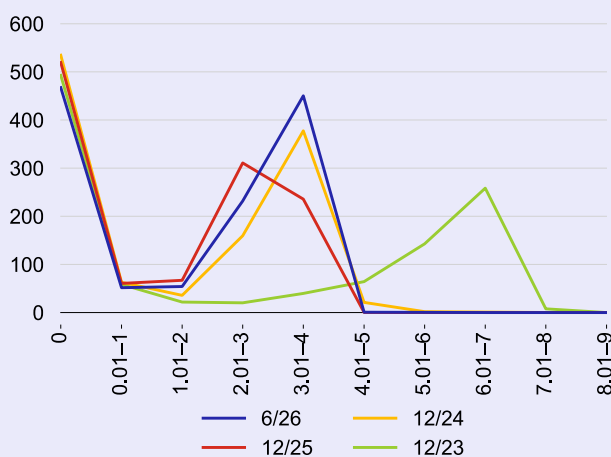
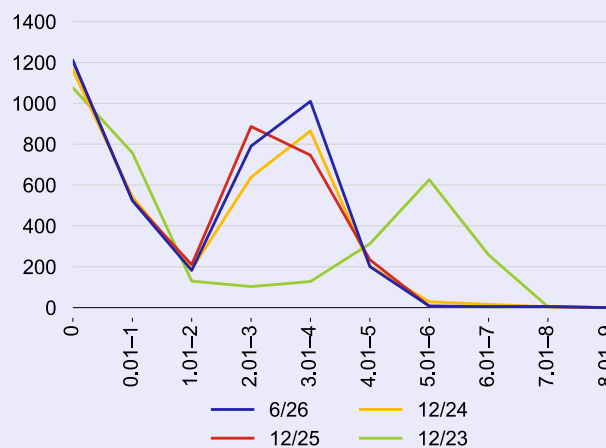


Chart 6
Household deposits

x-axis: interest rate bands in %; y-axis: volumes in CZK billions; stocks of deposits



¹ This topic was also discussed in the box [How client interest rates on loans and deposits have changed over the last two years](#) in the Summer 2023 MPR.

Box 3: An analysis of consumer credit growth and its links with the housing market

The recent rapid growth in consumer credit provided by banks raises the question of whether it reflects the usual relationship with consumption, or whether it is linked with the mortgage market recovery. In other words, households may be making greater use of some non-specific consumer loans to finance their housing-related needs or to cover other expenses associated with housing purchases. Granular data from the UVIS¹ survey do not indicate an increase in the simultaneous arrangement of consumer and mortgage loans for the same client at a single bank. However, this does not preclude the possibility of another member of the household taking out a consumer loan and using it flexibly to finance housing needs. In this box, this evidence is supplemented by an analysis of relationships at the aggregate level.

After stagnating in 2020–2021, the share of consumer credit in the loan portfolio has been increasing again since 2022. The total volume of consumer credit reached CZK 428 billion at the end of 2026 Q2, accounting for 15.8% of total bank loans to households. Around 85% of consumer loans have a maturity of more than five years, and roughly three-quarters of this category are non-specific loans. It is this segment that has recorded the strongest growth over the past year (see [Chart 1](#)). Quarterly genuinely new lending has risen from an average of CZK 22.6 billion in 2020–2023 to CZK 36.8 billion since 2024, reaching CZK 49.8 billion in 2026 Q2. Its ratio to final household consumption has meanwhile gone up from a long-term average of around 3% to 4.3%, so lending has been growing faster than consumption itself. This may indicate more intensive use of credit to finance consumption expenditure, but it may also point to a shift towards borrowing for other purposes.

The hypothesis of a link with housing loans is supported mainly by the concentration of growth in long-term non-specific loans and by the similar patterns in new mortgage and consumer lending recently. [Chart 2](#) shows that the two types of loans began to grow simultaneously in 2024 and continued to accelerate particularly during 2025 and early 2026. In addition to the statistics, this is confirmed by perceived demand data from the Bank Lending Survey (BLS). At the same time, the spread between interest rates on consumer credit and housing loans has narrowed to a historical low (see [Chart 3](#)).

However, growth in mortgages may not be the sole factor behind the higher demand for consumer credit. Consumer sentiment, income growth and a greater willingness to finance current expenditure through borrowing may also be playing a role. According to a correlation analysis (see [Table 1](#)), the long-term evolution of consumer credit is consistent with economic theory and the usual relationships.² Genuinely new consumer lending is correlated negatively with interest rates and positively with inflation. Among the monthly indicators, the strongest correlation is observed with sales of services and motor vehicles. Total retail sales are not significantly correlated, mainly owing to a weak correlation with food sales, whereas the correlation with non-food sales is positive

Chart 1

Growth in consumer credit is currently being driven primarily by long-term non-specific loans

y-o-y changes in %; contributions in pp

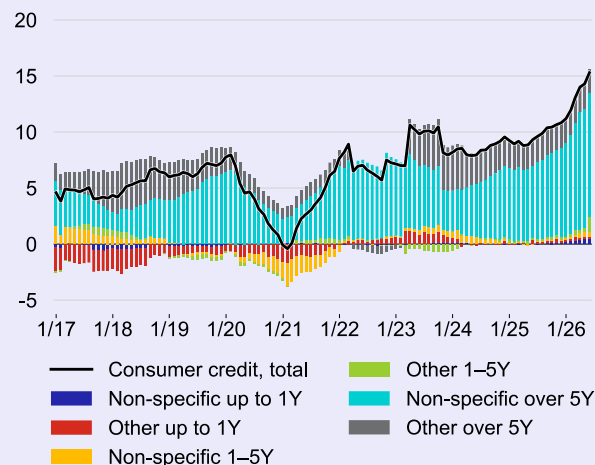


Chart 2

Genuinely new consumer credit has recently been growing in parallel with housing loans

genuinely new loans including increases; index: January 2015 = 100

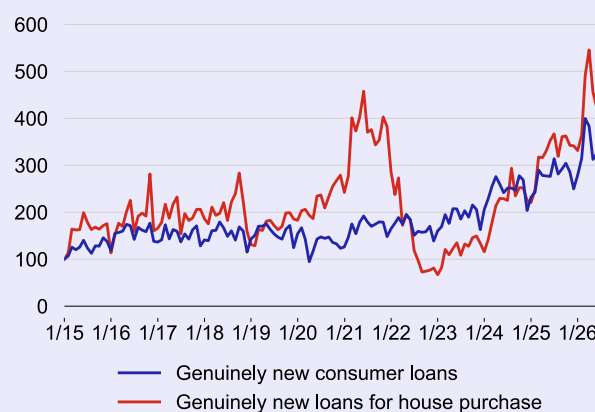
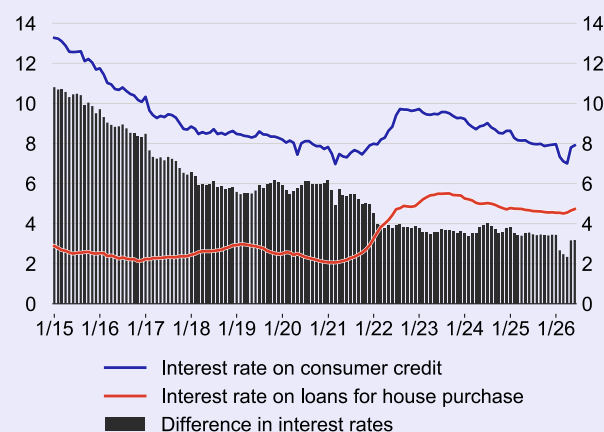


Chart 3

The spread between interest rates on consumer credit and housing loans has narrowed

interest rates in %; spread in pp



and statistically significant. Among the quarterly variables, consumer credit is most closely linked to banks' perceived demand as measured by the BLS, while the correlation with final consumption is driven primarily by spending on services (for example, holidays) and semi-durable goods (for example, consumer electronics).

Comparing the results for samples ending in January 2024 and May 2026 shows that most of the correlations remain stable.³ One of the few exceptions is new housing loans, for which the correlation coefficient is slightly higher in the sample ending in 2026 than in the sample ending in 2024. In addition, at the end of the sample, an analysis using a five-year rolling window indicates a shift in the maximum correlation from the contemporaneous relationship to a one-month lead of consumer credit. This time shift may reflect the faster response of consumer credit to common factors affecting household credit demand, due in part to the simpler and faster administrative process for arranging a loan. However, it is also consistent with the possibility that, for some households, consumer credit has recently replaced mortgage financing to some extent, particularly in the case of less costly housing-related needs.

Additional evidence can be obtained from a benchmark linear regression model⁴ that explains consumer credit growth using inflation, interest rates, services sales, perceived demand and changes in lending standards from the BLS. This model explains past developments reasonably well (see [Chart 4](#)), but since 2025 it has been unable to fully explain the increase in consumer credit. For this year, the model predicts considerably lower growth than has actually been observed.

When housing loans are added to the model, the model path becomes much closer to the actual one. The contribution of this variable is particularly evident at the end of the sample, whereas in earlier periods the results of the two specifications differ only marginally. The mean absolute error of the benchmark model for January–May 2026 is 3.7 pp, compared with only 0.5 pp for the augmented specification. Including housing loans thus reduces the average estimation error by 87%. This supports the hypothesis that the current growth in consumer credit is linked not only to standard macroeconomic factors, but also to developments in the mortgage market. From a monetary policy perspective, it is therefore appropriate to analyse consumer credit and mortgage loans jointly when forecasting lending and assessing household indebtedness.

Table 1

Consumer credit is closely correlated with its main macroeconomic determinants; its correlation with housing loans has strengthened recently

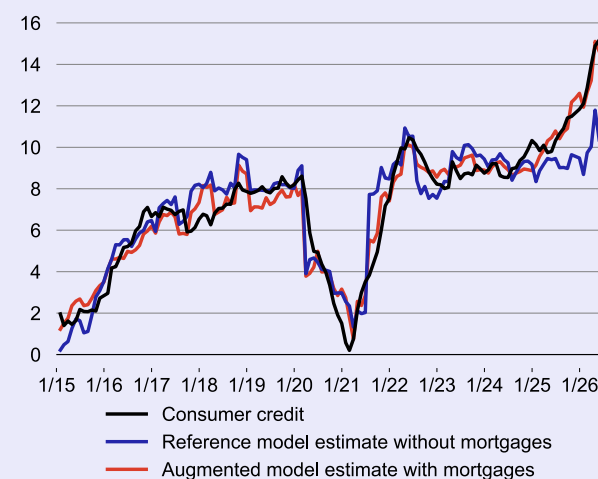
	Lag	Correlation	
		up to 1/24	up to 5/26
MONTHLY			
Interest rate on genuinely new consumer loans ^{a)}	0	-0.47 ***	-0.52 ***
Inflation ^{a)}	-3	0.75	0.81
Genuinely new loans for house purchase	1	0.34 **	0.38 ***
Sales in retail and services			
Retail sales excluding fuel	0	0.39 *	0.39
Motor vehicles	0	0.55 ***	0.54 ***
Non-food goods	0	0.41 **	0.40 **
Services	0	0.44 **	0.43 **
QUARTERLY			
Total final household consumption	0	0.58 ***	0.57 ***
Short-term	0	0.27	0.28
Medium-term	0	0.45 **	0.44 **
Long-term	0	0.40	0.40
Services	0	0.57 ***	0.55 ***
Gross fixed cap. formation of households	2	0.31 *	0.31 *
Demand (BLS) ^{b)}	0	0.72 ***	0.70 ***
Standards (BLS) ^{b)}	0	-0.37 *	-0.40 **

Note: The table reports the correlations between y-o-y growth in genuinely new consumer credit at time t and y-o-y growth in the individual variables with the lag indicated. The exceptions are: (a) correlations between a level and an index, and (b) correlations between a level and a net percentage share. The data used for calculating the correlations start in January 2015. Statistical significance levels: *** $p < 0.001$, ** $p < 0.01$, * $p < 0.05$.

Chart 4

Including housing loans substantially improves the model's ability to capture the recent acceleration in consumer credit growth

growth rate in %; actual values and model estimates



¹ Survey of consumer loans secured by residential property.

² To calculate the correlations, the variables are seasonally adjusted and expressed in constant prices, with the exception of interest rates, housing loans, inflation and the BLS indicators. The House Price Index is used as the deflator for households' gross fixed capital formation. Due to potential autocorrelation, statistical significance is tested using the coefficient of the relevant lag/lead in a regression with Newey–West errors. The sample covers the period from January 2015 to May 2026 or, in the case of quarterly variables, from 2015 Q1 to 2026 Q1.

³ For the monthly data, correlation stability was also assessed using a rolling-window approach. Correlation coefficients were repeatedly calculated for overlapping five-year (60-month) periods, with each successive window shifted forward by one month. The results suggest that the coefficients on the main variables are stable over time, while those for housing loans increase only in the final windows.

⁴ The intention was to design a benchmark model that reflects the standard determinants of consumer credit growth, rather than to develop a model for forecasting future developments.

ABBREVIATIONS

AI	artificial intelligence	HPI	house price index
CF	Consensus Forecasts	ICT	information and communication technology
CNB	Czech National Bank	ifo	index of economic confidence in Germany
CPI	consumer price index	ILO	International Labour Organization
CPIH	experimental consumer price index incorporating prices of older properties	IMF	International Monetary Fund
CZK	Czech koruna	IRS	interest rate swap
CZSO	Czech Statistical Office	LFS	Labour Force Survey
DSTI	debt service-to-income	LTV	loan-to-value
DTI	debt-to-income	LUCI	Labour Utilisation Composite Index
ECB	European Central Bank	M1, M3	monetary aggregates
ESA	European System of Accounts	MFIs	monetary financial institutions
ESCB	European System of Central Banks	m-o-m	month-on-month
ESR	electronic sales registration	MPR	Monetary Policy Report
ETS	emissions trading system	NAIRU	non-accelerating inflation rate of unemployment
EU	European Union	NGEU	NextGenerationEU (a plan to boost Europe's economy)
EUR	euro	PMI	Purchasing Managers Index
EURIBOR	Euro Interbank Offered Rate	pp	percentage points
FDI	foreign direct investment	PPI	producer price index
FECF	Foreign Exchange Consensus Forecasts	PRIBOR	Prague Interbank Offered Rate
Fed	US central bank	q-o-q	quarter-on-quarter
FMIE	Financial Market Inflation Expectations	repo rate	repurchase agreement rate
FOMC	Federal Open Market Committee	rhs	right-hand scale
FRA	forward rate agreement	SES	supported energy sources
GDP	gross domestic product	SOFR	Secured Overnight Financing Rate
GNP	gross national product	USD	US dollar
GVA	gross value added	VAT	value added tax
HICP	Harmonised Index of Consumer Prices	y-o-y	year-on-year
HP filter	Hodrick-Prescott filter		

KEY MACROECONOMIC INDICATORS

	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028
DEMAND AND SUPPLY												
Gross domestic product												
GDP (CZK bn, current p., seas. adjusted)	5187.1	5482.7	5891.8	5830.5	6305.6	7048.2	7670.2	8066.8	8577.2	9016.0	9518.3	10003.6
Output gap (in % of GDP, seas. adjusted)	1.5	2.1	2.5	-0.5	1.1	0.9	-0.9	-0.8	0.0	-0.3	0.0	0.1
GDP (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	5.4	2.8	3.5	-5.3	4.0	2.9	0.2	1.1	2.7	2.2	2.7	2.5
GDP (% , q-o-q, real terms, seas. adjusted)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Household consumption (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	4.5	3.4	3.0	-6.6	4.1	0.4	-2.7	2.5	2.6	3.2	3.1	2.3
Government consumption (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	1.7	3.5	2.6	4.1	1.5	0.4	3.2	3.1	2.2	0.7	0.9	2.0
Gross capital formation (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	5.8	6.3	5.5	-9.2	18.3	10.2	-5.9	-4.9	5.8	5.5	3.0	2.6
Gross fixed capital formation (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	3.2	8.9	7.3	-4.8	6.6	6.3	4.5	-2.6	3.3	4.5	2.8	2.6
Exports of goods and services (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	7.6	3.5	1.1	-8.6	8.0	5.2	2.8	1.8	3.5	5.4	4.6	4.6
Imports of goods and services (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	6.4	5.5	1.1	-8.5	13.5	6.0	-0.9	0.6	4.7	7.3	4.5	4.3
Net exports (percentage points, contributions to GDP growth)	1.4	-1.1	0.1	-0.6	-2.9	-0.3	2.6	0.8	-0.5	-0.9	0.2	0.3
PRICES												
Main price indicators												
Consumer Price Index (% , y-o-y, average)	2.5	2.1	2.8	3.2	3.8	15.1	10.7	2.4	2.5	2.0	2.5	2.4
Administered prices (% , y-o-y, average, 15.79%*)	0.0	1.8	4.4	3.1	-0.2	20.9	27.8	6.3	0.9	-1.0	2.5	3.2
Food prices (incl. alcoholic beverages and tobacco, % , y-o-y, average, 25.15%*)	3.7	1.6	2.6	4.2	2.1	12.9	10.0	0.7	3.4	0.1	2.8	2.0
Core inflation (% , y-o-y, average, 56.03%*)	2.4	2.1	2.7	3.3	4.8	13.2	7.6	2.5	2.7	2.9	2.4	2.2
Fuel prices (% , y-o-y, average, 3.03%*)	6.7	6.3	-0.4	-11.4	16.7	33.6	-12.1	-0.8	-6.7	14.7	-2.0	4.5
Monetary policy-relevant inflation (% , y-o-y, average)	2.5	2.1	2.9	3.2	3.9	14.6	10.6	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.4	2.4
Other price indicators												
Industrial producer prices (% , y-o-y, average)	1.8	2.0	2.6	0.1	7.1	24.3	5.0	0.8	-0.8	1.0	1.8	0.9
Agricultural prices (% , y-o-y, average)	7.4	-0.1	5.4	-3.8	7.4	31.8	-5.5	-6.6	8.4	-9.6	1.6	-1.6
Prices of new property (% , y-o-y, average)	14.0	11.8	7.9	9.1	18.3	19.0	-1.4	5.1	13.6	6.9	5.9	5.6
GDP deflator (% , y-o-y, seas. adjusted)	1.7	2.8	3.8	4.5	4.0	8.7	8.6	4.0	3.5	2.8	2.8	2.5
LABOUR MARKET												
Average monthly wage (% , y-o-y, nominal terms)	6.7	8.2	7.9	4.6	5.8	4.3	7.2	6.6	6.6	7.3	5.7	5.2
Average monthly wage in market sectors (% , y-o-y, nominal terms)	6.7	7.7	7.6	4.1	6.1	4.7	7.4	7.5	6.8	7.5	5.8	5.4
Average monthly wage in non-market sectors (% , y-o-y, nominal terms)	7.1	10.2	9.2	6.9	4.4	2.6	6.4	2.8	6.2	6.4	5.4	4.2
Average monthly wage (% , y-o-y, real terms)	4.2	5.9	5.0	1.4	2.0	-9.3	-3.1	4.1	4.1	5.2	3.1	2.7
Unit labour costs (% , y-o-y)	3.8	6.5	4.2	5.9	3.1	6.1	8.8	4.8	4.5	5.3	3.3	2.9
Aggregate labour productivity (% , y-o-y)	3.8	1.7	3.7	-3.0	3.0	1.8	-1.5	0.7	1.3	1.6	2.4	2.2
ILO general unemployment rate (% , average, age 15–64, seas. adjusted)	2.9	2.2	2.0	2.6	2.8	2.2	2.6	2.7	2.9	3.1	3.0	2.9
Share of unemployed persons (MLSA, %, average, seas. adjusted)	4.2	3.2	2.8	3.6	3.8	3.4	3.6	3.8	4.4	5.0	4.9	4.8
Full-time employment (% , y-o-y)	2.2	1.5	-0.3	-1.7	0.2	0.7	0.5	0.0	-0.3	0.7	0.4	0.3
PUBLIC FINANCE												
Government budget balance (ESA2010, CZK bn, current prices)	75.6	48.3	16.7	-329.3	-312.3	-216.3	-286.1	-163.3	-183.7	-236.0	-280.2	-285.0
Government budget balance/GDP** (% , nominal terms)	1.5	0.9	0.3	-5.6	-5.0	-3.1	-3.7	-2.0	-2.1	-2.6	-2.9	-2.9
Structural balance/GDP (% , nominal terms)	0.9	0.5	-0.5	-5.7	-5.3	-3.2	-3.3	-1.5	-2.1	-2.5	-2.9	-2.9
Government debt (ESA2010, CZK bn, current prices)	1749.7	1734.6	1740.3	2149.7	2566.8	2997.6	3234.1	3488.5	3786.3	4098.9	4434.7	4771.8
Government debt/GDP** (% , nominal terms)	33.8	31.7	29.6	36.9	40.7	42.5	42.2	43.2	44.2	45.5	46.6	47.7
MONEY, INTEREST RATES AND EXCHANGE RATES												
M3 (% , y-o-y, average)	11.7	6.6	6.3	9.0	9.6	6.4	8.6	6.5	4.2	5.9	7.4	8.2
2W repo rate (% , average)	0.2	1.1	1.9	0.8	0.9	5.9	7.0	5.1	3.6	3.7	3.8	3.6
3M PRIBOR (% , average)	0.4	1.3	2.1	0.9	1.1	6.3	7.1	5.0	3.6	3.7	3.9	3.7
CZK/USD (average)	23.4	21.7	22.9	23.2	21.7	23.4	22.2	23.2	21.9	20.9	20.7	20.4
CZK/EUR (average)	26.3	25.6	25.7	26.5	25.6	24.6	24.0	25.1	24.7	24.3	24.4	24.3
EXTERNAL RELATIONS												
Current account												
Goods and services, net (CZK bn, current prices)	394.2	332.6	358.4	388.8	232.2	75.9	377.6	525.9	499.9	420.6	464.7	533.1
Current account (CZK bn, current prices)	79.8	21.5	19.6	102.5	-129.7	-330.3	-8.5	136.9	62.6	-49.4	-6.7	40.2
Current account/GDP (% , nominal terms)	1.5	0.4	0.3	1.8	-2.1	-4.7	-0.1	1.7	0.7	-0.5	-0.1	0.4
Foreign direct investment												
Direct investment (CZK bn, current prices)	-45.9	-51.0	-137.1	-149.1	-28.5	-83.5	-76.5	-14.7	-49.3	-125.0	-35.0	-25.0
EXTERNAL ASSUMPTIONS												
3M EURIBOR (% , average)	-0.3	-0.3	-0.4	-0.4	-0.5	0.3	3.4	3.6	2.2	2.4	2.6	2.5
USD/EUR (average)	1.13	1.18	1.12	1.14	1.18	1.05	1.08	1.08	1.13	1.16	1.18	1.19
Foreign GDP (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	2.8	1.7	1.3	-5.3	4.9	2.5	0.2	0.2	0.6	0.9	1.3	1.3
Foreign GDP (% , q-o-q, real terms, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Foreign HICP (% , y-o-y, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	1.6	2.0	1.5	0.6	2.9	8.9	6.7	2.5	2.5	2.7	2.3	2.2
Foreign PPI (% , y-o-y, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	2.4	3.1	1.1	-1.3	9.6	32.8	2.8	-5.5	-0.5	2.2	1.5	0.6
Brent crude oil (in USD/barrel, average)	54.8	71.6	64.2	43.2	70.8	98.9	82.2	79.8	68.2	84.7	76.2	72.9

* constant weights in current consumer basket

** CNB calculation

- data not available/forecasted/released

data in bold = CNB forecast

KEY MACROECONOMIC INDICATORS

	2026				2027				2028			
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
DEMAND AND SUPPLY												
Gross domestic product												
GDP (CZK bn, current p., seas. adjusted)	2200.0	2236.3	2272.1	2307.7	2339.8	2364.6	2392.2	2421.8	2454.9	2485.1	2516.0	2547.5
Output gap (in % of GDP, seas. adjusted)	-0.4	-0.4	-0.2	-0.1	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
GDP (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	2.2	2.2	2.2	2.2	2.8	2.8	2.8	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.5	2.5
GDP (% , q-o-q, real terms, seas. adjusted)	0.2	0.6	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.6
Household consumption (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	3.3	2.8	3.6	3.1	3.6	3.5	2.8	2.7	2.4	2.3	2.2	2.1
Government consumption (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	1.4	1.4	-0.3	0.1	0.3	0.2	1.5	1.6	1.8	2.0	2.1	2.2
Gross capital formation (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	6.2	5.0	5.1	5.8	3.6	3.2	2.8	2.5	2.4	2.6	2.7	2.7
Gross fixed capital formation (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	6.0	5.0	4.0	3.2	2.4	3.1	3.0	2.8	2.7	2.6	2.6	2.5
Exports of goods and services (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	5.3	5.2	5.3	5.6	3.9	4.7	4.9	4.9	4.8	4.7	4.5	4.3
Imports of goods and services (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted)	7.9	6.9	7.1	7.4	4.1	4.7	4.7	4.7	4.6	4.4	4.3	4.1
Net exports (percentage points, contributions to GDP growth)	-1.3	-0.8	-0.7	-0.7	0.0	0.2	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.3	0.3
PRICES												
Main price indicators												
Consumer Price Index (% , y-o-y, average)	1.6	2.0	1.9	2.4	2.8	2.4	2.5	2.2	2.5	2.4	2.4	2.4
Administered prices (% , y-o-y, average, 15.79%*)	-1.3	-1.3	-1.2	-0.2	2.6	2.6	2.5	2.2	3.1	3.1	3.2	3.2
Food prices (incl. alcoholic beverages and tobacco, % , y-o-y, average, 25.15%*)	1.0	-0.4	-0.8	0.4	1.9	2.8	3.5	2.7	2.1	2.0	2.0	2.1
Core inflation (% , y-o-y, average, 56.03%*)	2.8	2.9	2.9	3.0	2.7	2.5	2.4	2.2	2.3	2.2	2.2	2.1
Fuel prices (% , y-o-y, average, 3.03%*)	-1.5	24.6	19.8	15.9	8.8	-7.0	-5.6	-4.2	4.0	4.6	4.4	5.0
Monetary policy-relevant inflation (% , y-o-y, average)	1.9	2.4	2.2	2.7	2.8	2.3	2.4	2.1	2.4	2.4	2.4	2.4
Other price indicators												
Industrial producer prices (% , y-o-y, average)	-2.3	1.3	2.1	2.9	3.7	1.6	1.3	0.8	0.8	0.9	0.9	1.0
Agricultural prices (% , y-o-y, average)	-8.1	-12.4	-10.8	-6.9	0.5	1.6	3.4	0.9	-1.2	-1.7	-1.8	-1.6
Prices of new property (% , y-o-y, average)	10.0	6.2	5.4	6.0	6.3	5.8	5.7	5.9	6.0	5.9	5.4	5.0
GDP deflator (% , y-o-y, seas. adjusted)	2.9	2.7	3.0	2.8	3.5	2.8	2.5	2.2	2.3	2.5	2.6	2.6
LABOUR MARKET												
Average monthly wage (% , y-o-y, nominal terms)	8.1	7.3	7.1	6.6	6.0	5.7	5.6	5.5	5.3	5.2	5.1	5.0
Average monthly wage in market sectors (% , y-o-y, nominal terms)	8.4	7.4	7.3	6.7	5.9	5.8	5.7	5.6	5.6	5.5	5.3	5.2
Average monthly wage in non-market sectors (% , y-o-y, nominal terms)	6.9	6.7	6.0	6.2	6.6	5.5	4.9	4.8	4.2	4.1	4.3	4.2
Average monthly wage (% , y-o-y, real terms)	6.4	5.1	5.1	4.2	3.1	3.2	3.0	3.2	2.8	2.8	2.7	2.5
Unit labour costs (% , y-o-y)	6.3	5.8	4.8	4.1	3.7	3.3	3.1	3.1	3.0	2.9	2.8	2.7
Aggregate labour productivity (% , y-o-y)	1.1	1.5	1.7	1.9	2.4	2.4	2.4	2.3	2.3	2.3	2.2	2.2
ILO general unemployment rate (% , average, age 15–64, seas. adjusted)	3.1	3.2	3.1	3.1	3.0	3.0	3.0	2.9	2.9	2.9	2.9	2.9
Share of unemployed persons (MLSA, %, average, seas. adjusted)	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.0	4.9	4.9	4.8	4.8	4.8	4.8	4.8
Full-time employment (% , y-o-y)	0.6	0.6	0.9	0.9	0.5	0.4	0.4	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
PUBLIC FINANCE												
Government budget balance (ESA2010, CZK bn, current prices)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Government budget balance/GDP** (% , nominal terms)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Structural balance/GDP (% , nominal terms)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Government debt (ESA2010, CZK bn, current prices)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Government debt/GDP** (% , nominal terms)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
MONEY, INTEREST RATES AND EXCHANGE RATES												
M3 (% , y-o-y, average)	5.3	6.0	6.1	6.3	6.8	7.2	7.7	7.8	8.2	8.2	8.2	8.3
2W repo rate (% , average)	3.5	3.5	3.7	3.9	3.8	3.8	3.8	3.8	3.8	3.7	3.6	3.4
3M PRIBOR (% , average)	3.5	3.6	3.8	4.0	3.9	3.9	3.9	3.9	3.9	3.8	3.7	3.5
CZK/USD (average)	20.8	20.9	21.1	20.9	20.8	20.8	20.7	20.6	20.5	20.4	20.4	20.3
CZK/EUR (average)	24.3	24.3	24.2	24.3	24.4	24.5	24.4	24.4	24.4	24.3	24.3	24.3
EXTERNAL RELATIONS												
Current account												
Goods and services, net (CZK bn, current prices)	149.1	109.9	78.9	82.7	149.7	128.1	91.2	95.7	166.1	146.0	107.7	113.3
Current account (CZK bn, current prices)	70.5	-46.1	-65.6	-8.2	65.3	-55.1	-24.8	7.9	78.4	-46.4	-13.2	21.5
Current account/GDP (% , nominal terms)	3.4	-2.0	-2.8	-0.3	3.0	-2.3	-1.0	0.3	3.4	-1.8	-0.5	0.8
Foreign direct investment												
Direct investment (CZK bn, current prices)	-144.7	6.6	6.6	6.6	-8.8	-8.8	-8.8	-8.8	-6.2	-6.2	-6.2	-6.2
EXTERNAL ASSUMPTIONS												
3M EURIBOR (% , average)	2.1	2.2	2.5	2.6	2.6	2.7	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.6	2.5	2.5
USD/EUR (average)	1.17	1.16	1.15	1.16	1.17	1.18	1.18	1.19	1.19	1.19	1.19	1.20
Foreign GDP (% , y-o-y, real terms, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	0.6	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.1	1.2	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.3	1.3	1.2
Foreign GDP (% , q-o-q, real terms, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.3	0.3	0.4	0.4	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
Foreign HICP (% , y-o-y, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	2.4	2.9	2.8	2.8	2.5	2.3	2.2	2.1	2.2	2.2	2.3	2.3
Foreign PPI (% , y-o-y, seas. adjusted, effective EA)	-1.7	2.9	3.4	4.2	4.1	1.3	0.5	0.1	0.3	0.5	0.7	0.8
Brent crude oil (in USD/barrel, average)	78.4	96.7	83.1	80.7	78.3	76.6	75.4	74.4	73.7	73.2	72.6	72.2

* constant weights in current consumer basket

** CNB calculation

- data not available/forecasted/released

data in bold = CNB forecast

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